TRANSIT

Customer Satisfaction Survey

SPRING 2025

Research
September 2025

Customer Satisfaction Survey Background

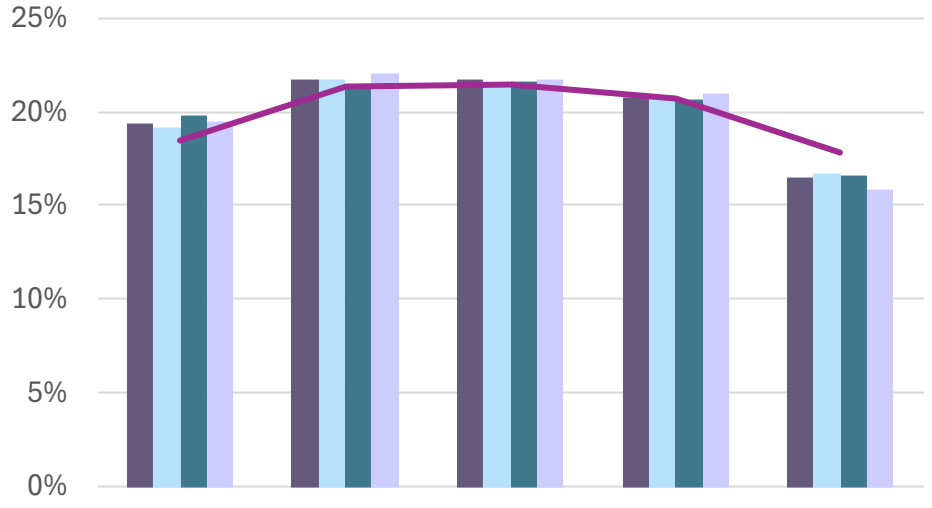
- Covers all modes – Bus, Rail, Light Rail & Access Link
- Conducted in Spring and Fall
- Methodology has remained consistent to track scores over time
  - Customers rate their satisfaction with service traits on a scale of 0 to 10
  - Customers identify the most important service traits
- Survey is administered online with an extensive campaign to increase participation and boost response rates in target markets

Spring 2025 Survey Background

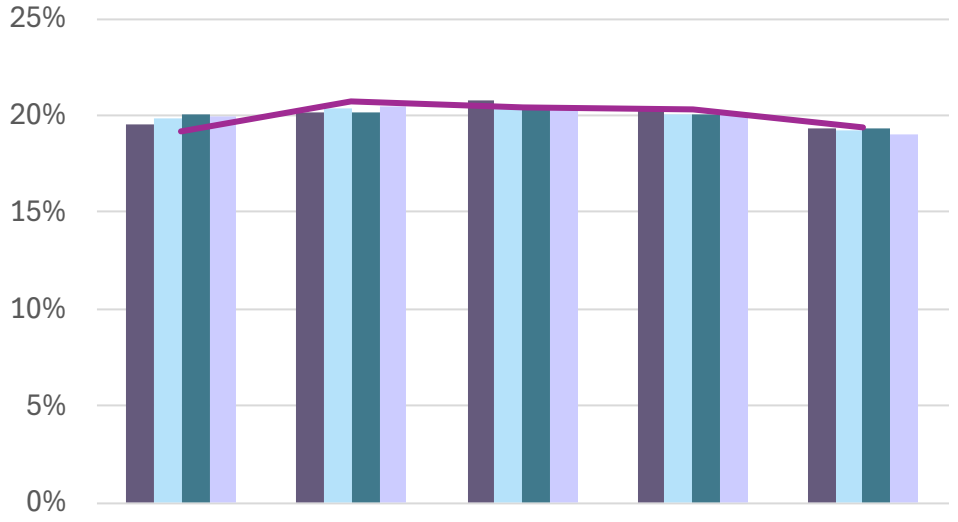
- Conducted from June 16th through July 6th
- After the rail strike was settled and as the fare change was being implemented
- Received about 29,000 surveys from customers
- Survey included standard Customer Satisfaction questions and COVID-related questions
- To encourage more participation -- offered 250 NJT Rewards Points to all customers that completed the survey and were a member or signed up for NJT Rewards

COVID-Related Findings
Distribution of Weekday WORK TRIPS on NJ TRANSIT by Day of the Week

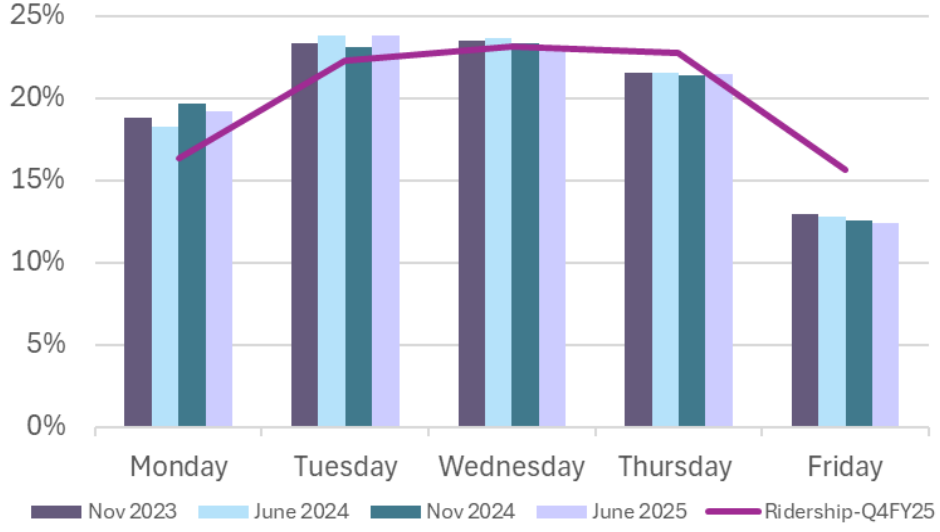
Bus – NY Interstate



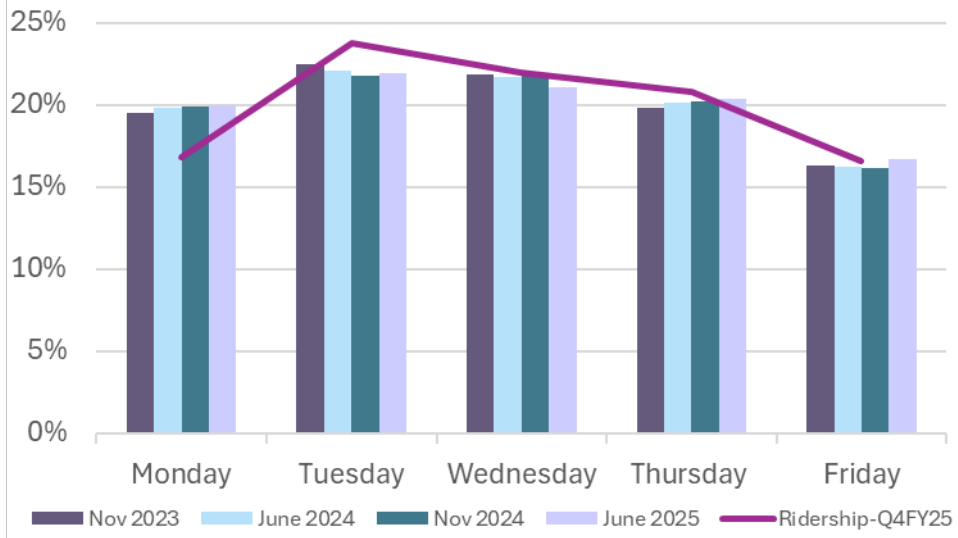
Bus – North Jersey Local, South Jersey & Contract



Rail



Light Rail

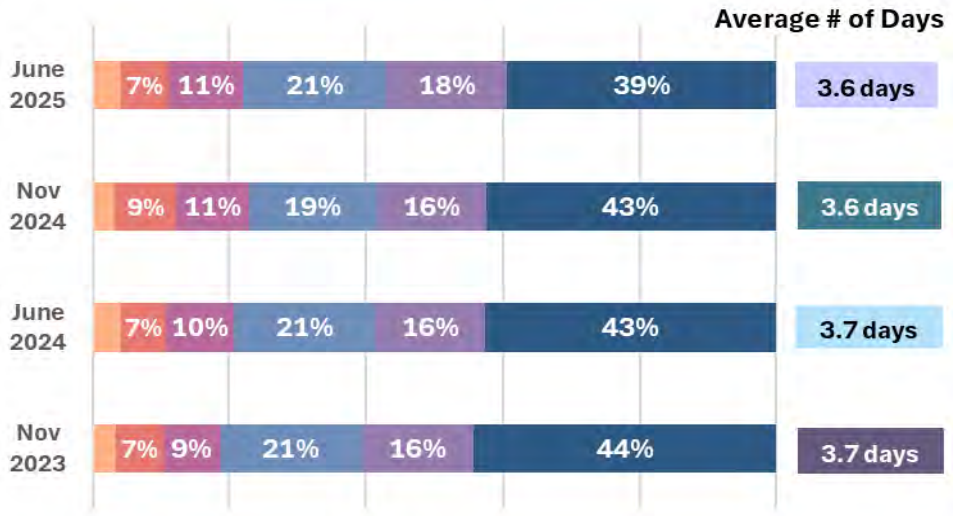


- Different day of the week travel patterns by mode
- Within each mode, consistent over the last four surveys and consistent with Ridership data

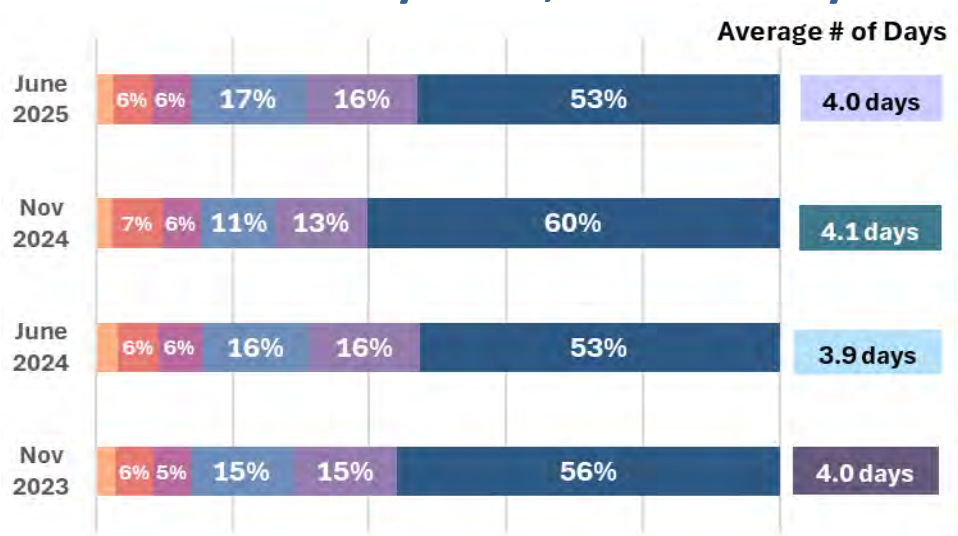
COVID-Related Findings

In the last 7 days, how many weekdays did you travel to your office/worksite?

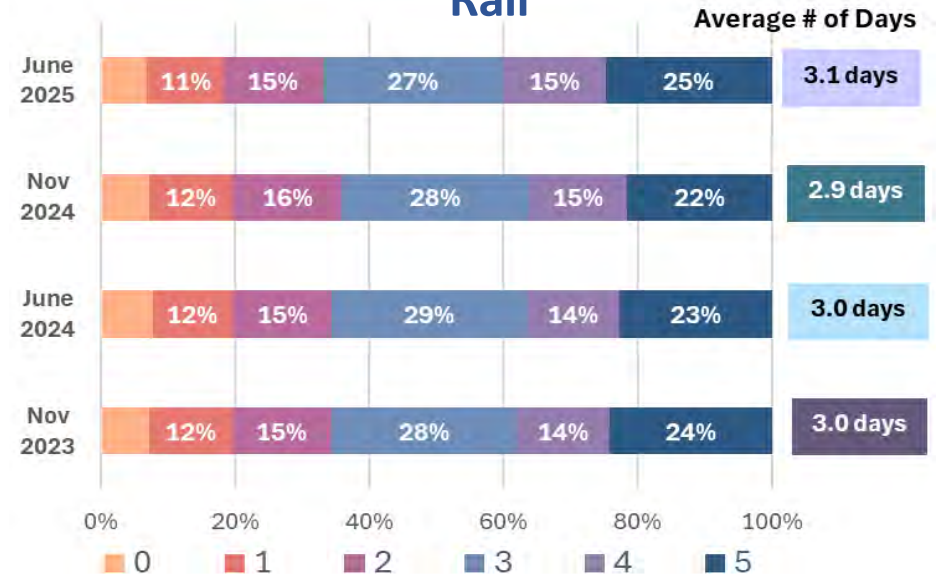
Bus – NY Interstate



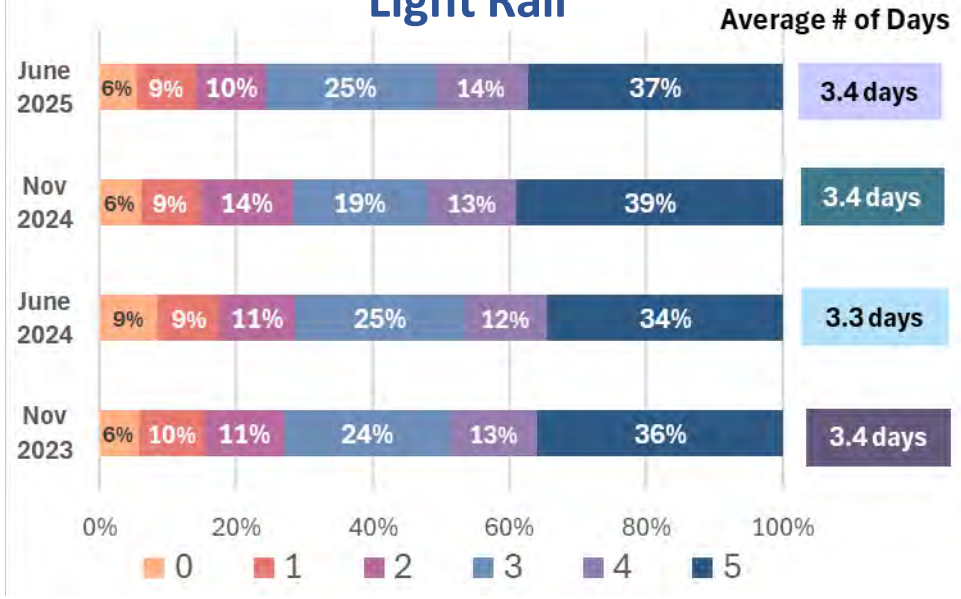
Bus – North Jersey Local, South Jersey & Contract



Rail



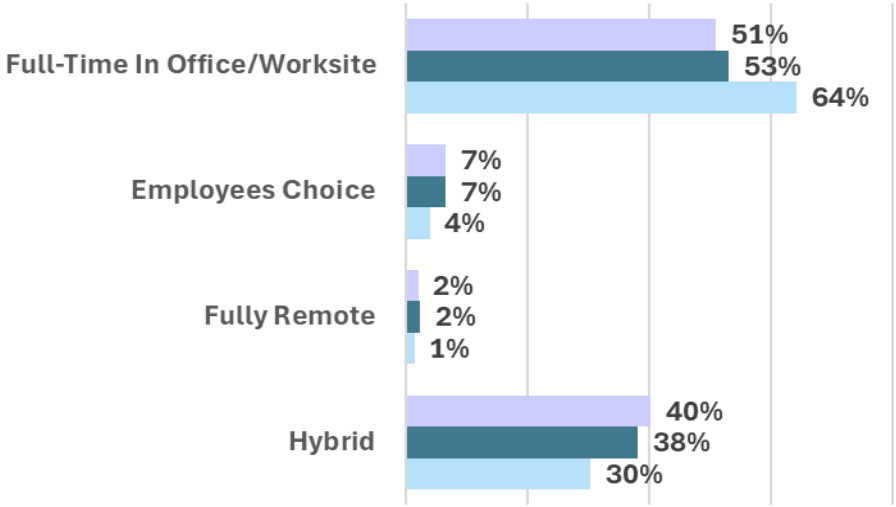
Light Rail



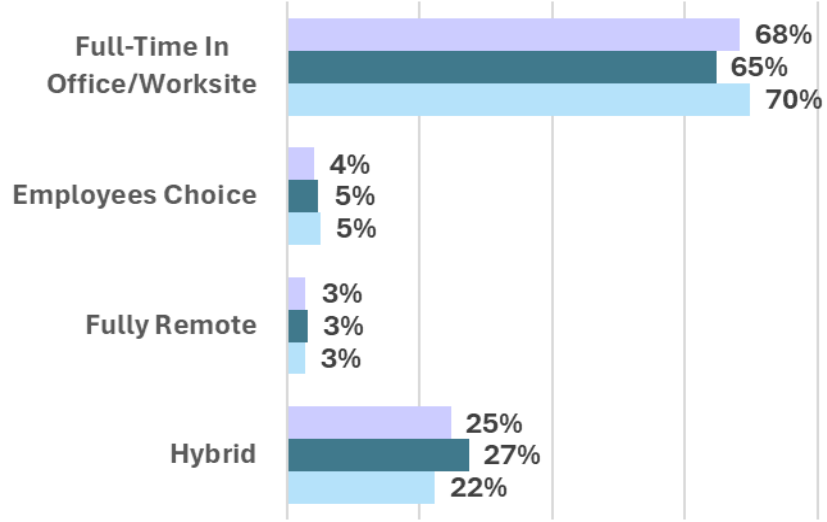
- Rail Riders traveling to their office increased from 2.9 days to 3.1 days

COVID-Related Findings
Your Company's Current Office/Worksite Attendance Policy

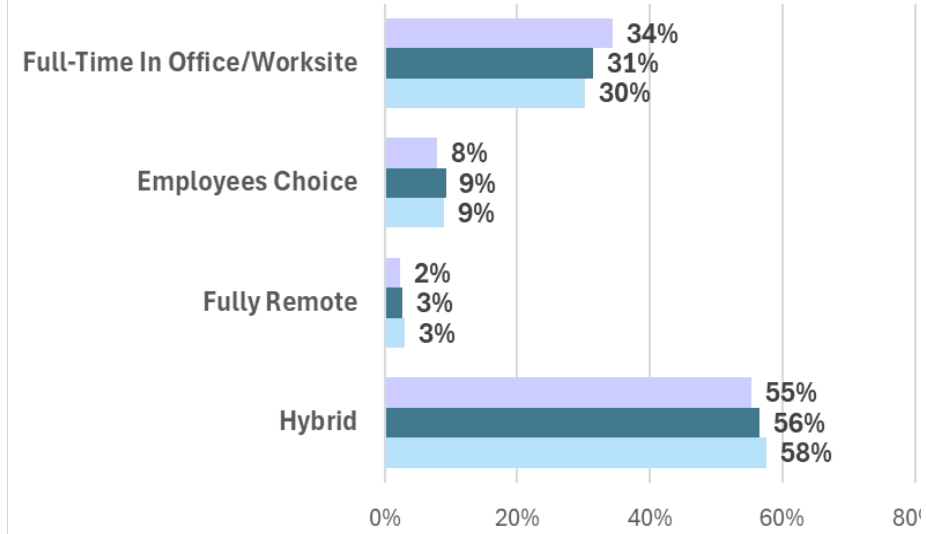
Bus – NY Interstate



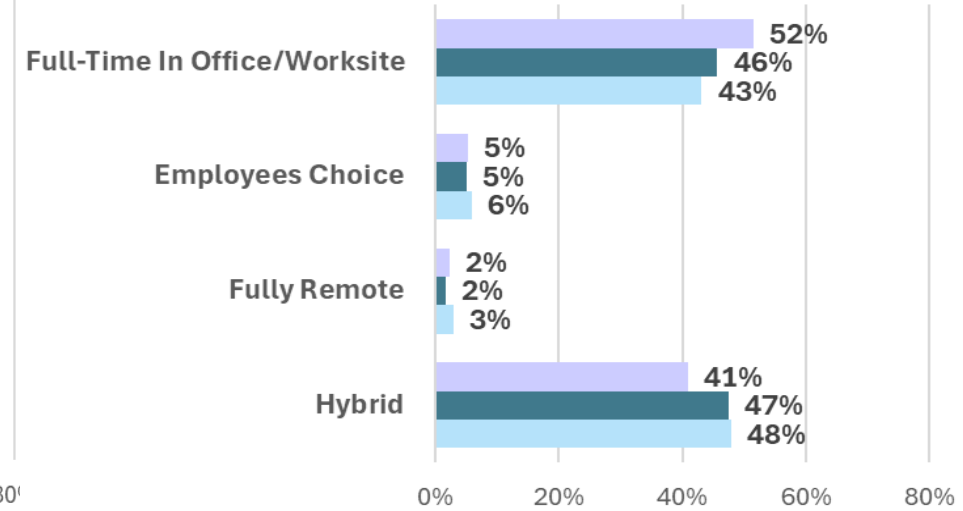
Bus – North Jersey Local, South Jersey & Contract



Rail



Light Rail

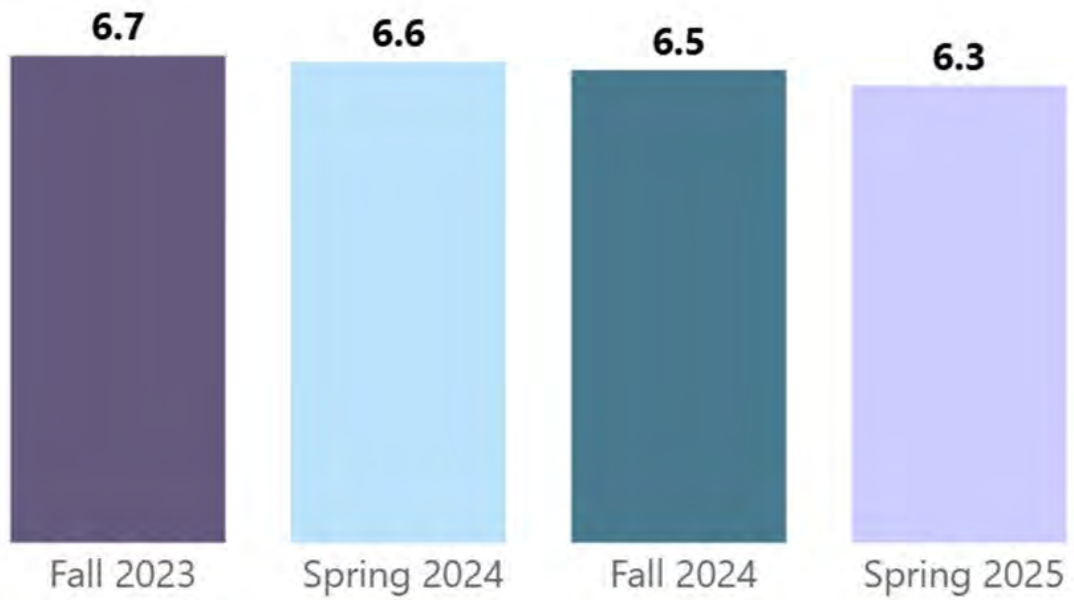


- Full time in the office increased since the Fall 2024 survey for Rail, Light Rail and Local Bus while hybrid decreased for all three markets.

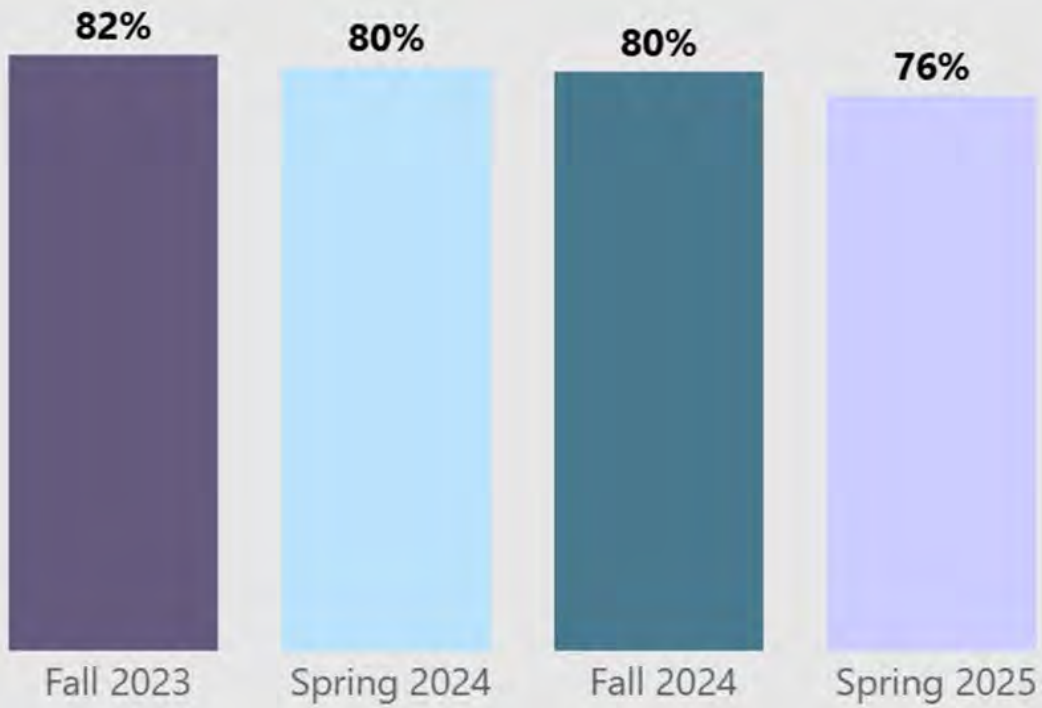
	Spring 2025
	Fall 2024
	Spring 2024

System-Wide Results

Overall Satisfaction Score

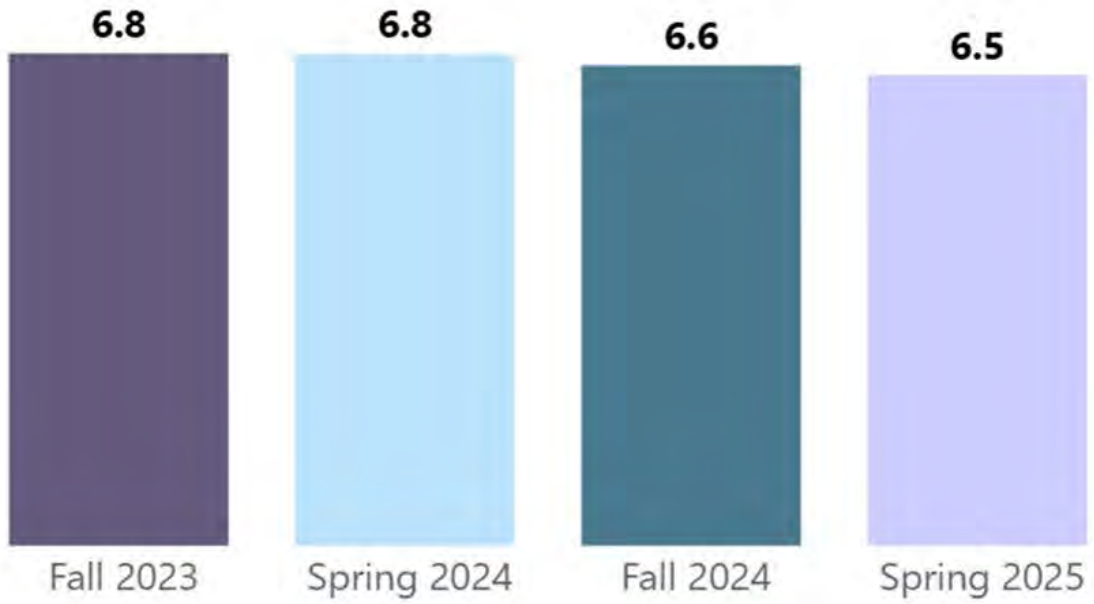


Likelihood to Recommend NJ TRANSIT

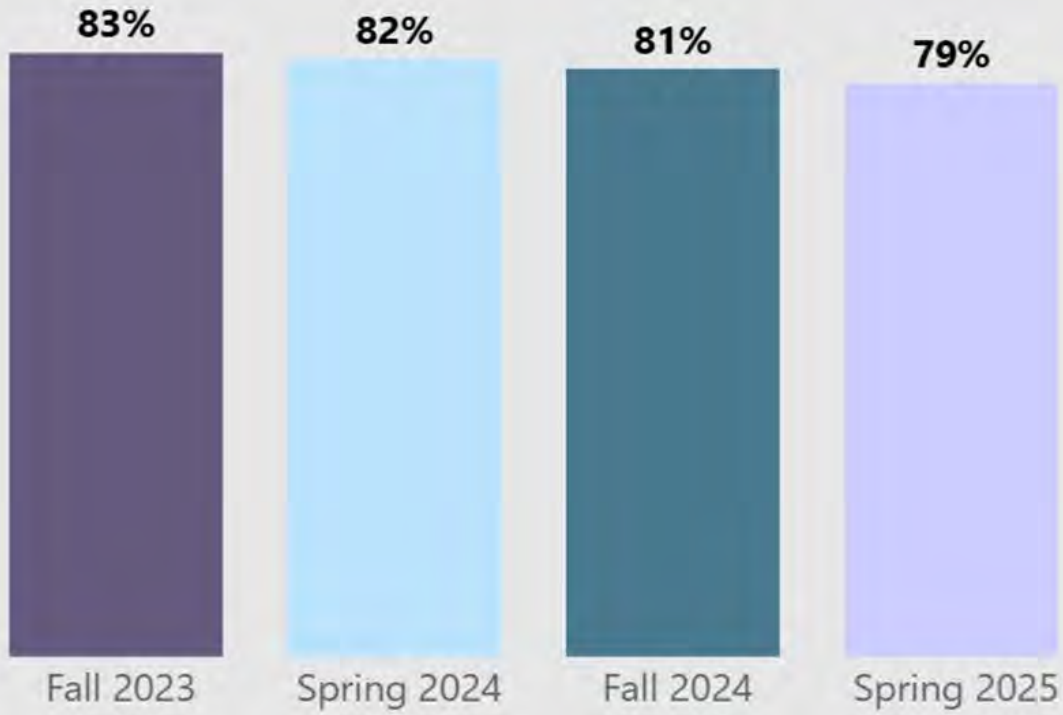


Bus System

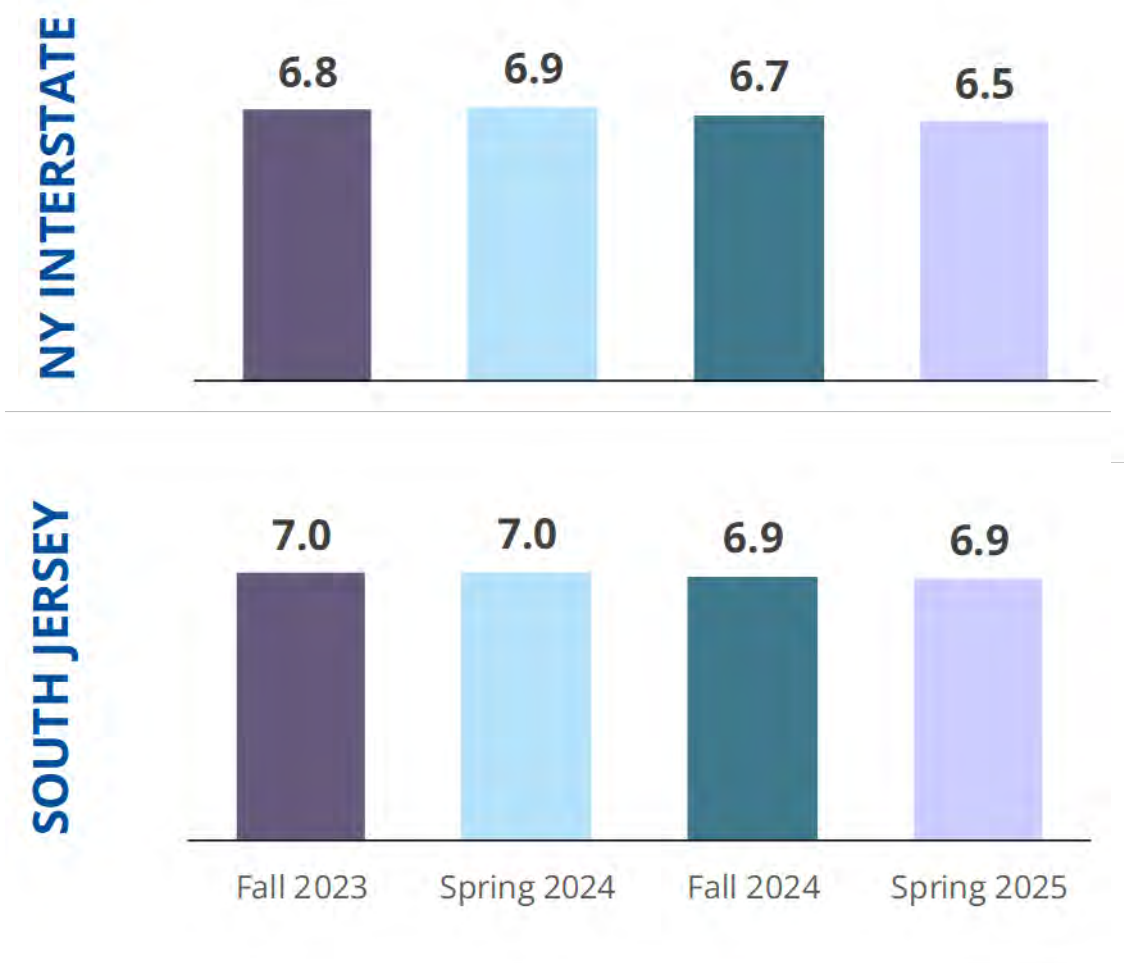
Overall Satisfaction Score



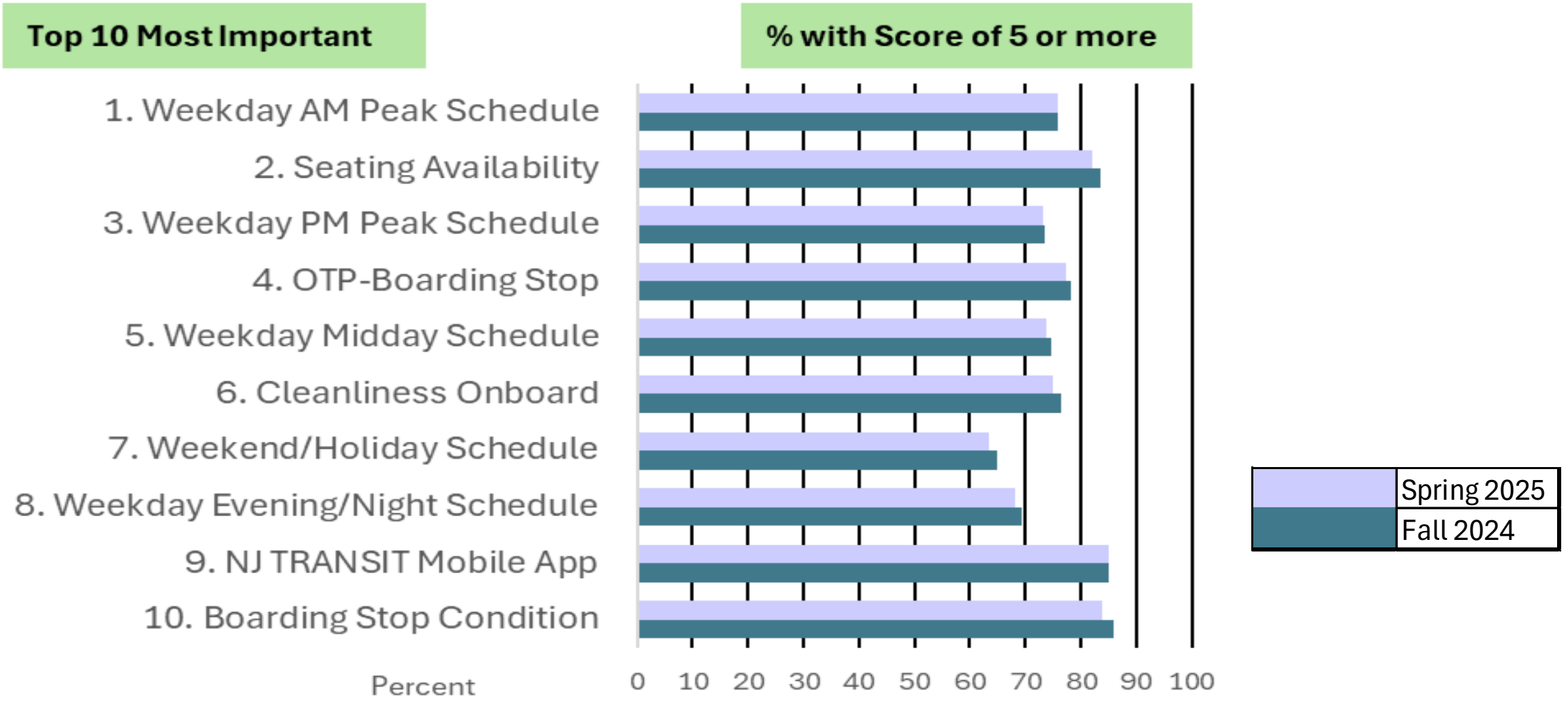
Likelihood to Recommend NJ TRANSIT



Overall Satisfaction Scores by Bus Market

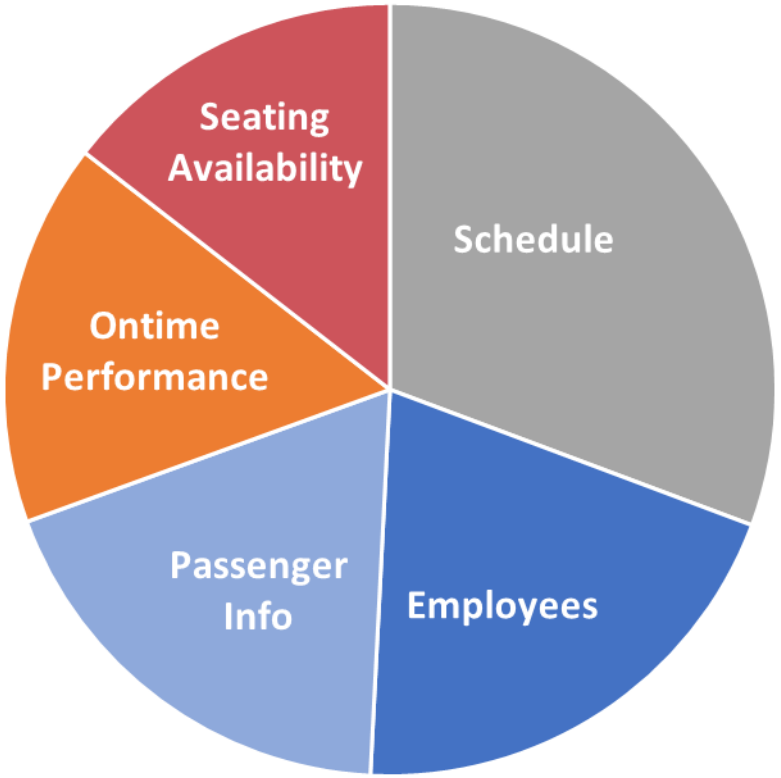


Top 10 Most Important Service Traits for Bus



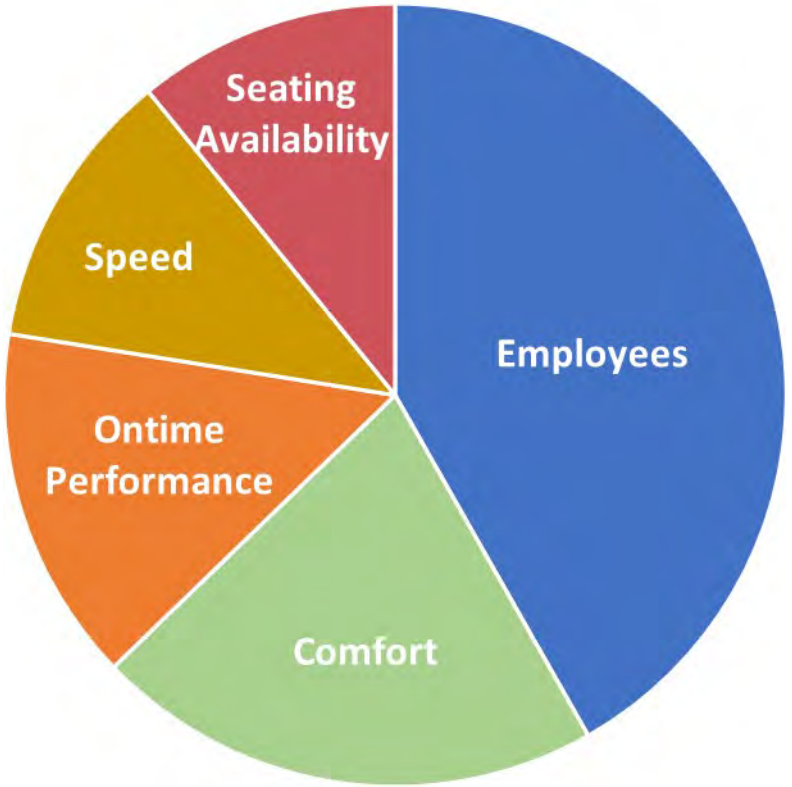
Top Topic Areas of BUS Comments

What is one thing we can do to **IMPROVE** your travel experience?



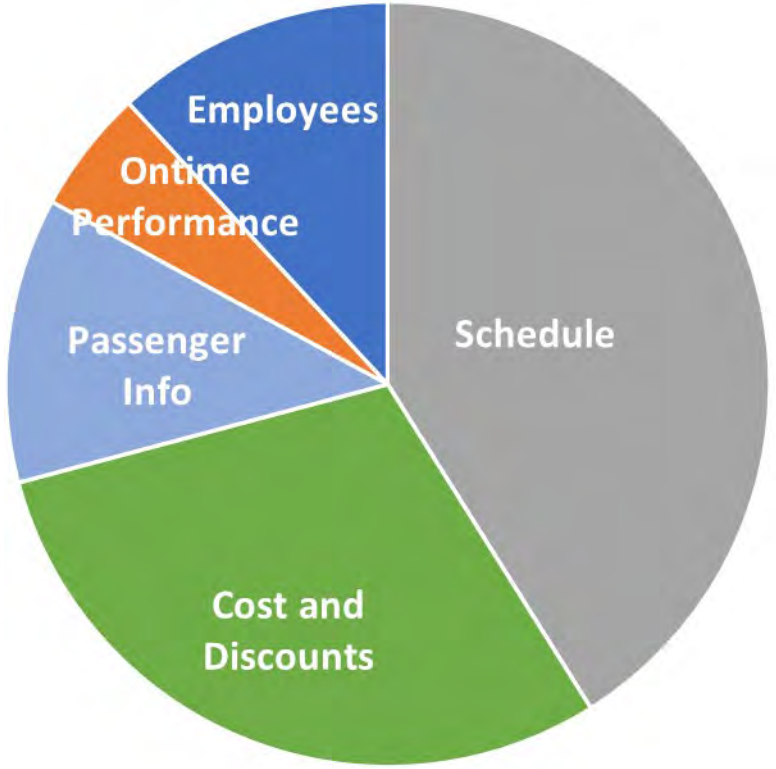
5,432 "Improve" Comments

What is one thing that you **LIKED** about your trip on NJ TRANSIT?



5,190 "Liked" Comments

What are the actions we could take to **ENCOURAGE** you to travel by NJ TRANSIT more frequently?

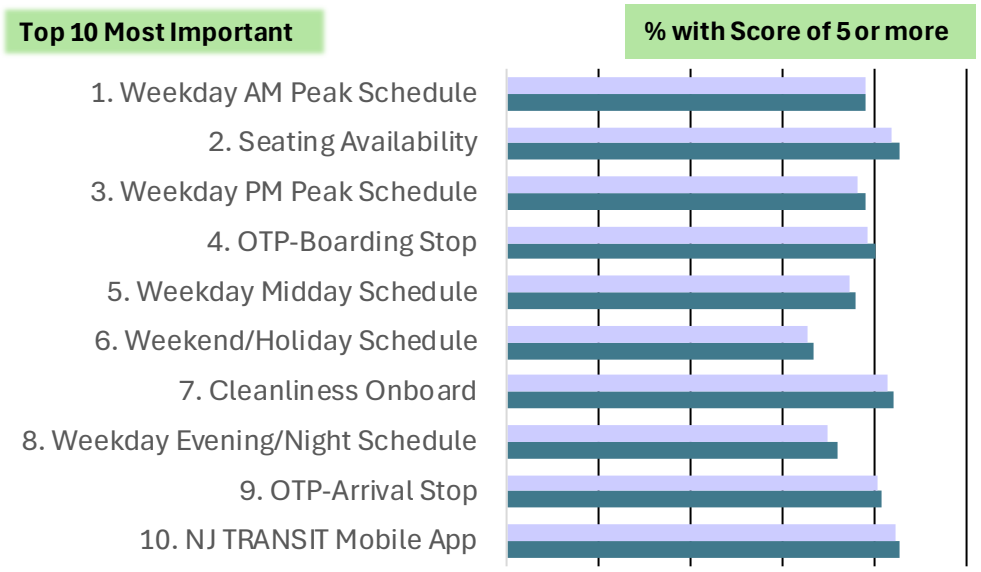


4,994 "Encourage" Comments

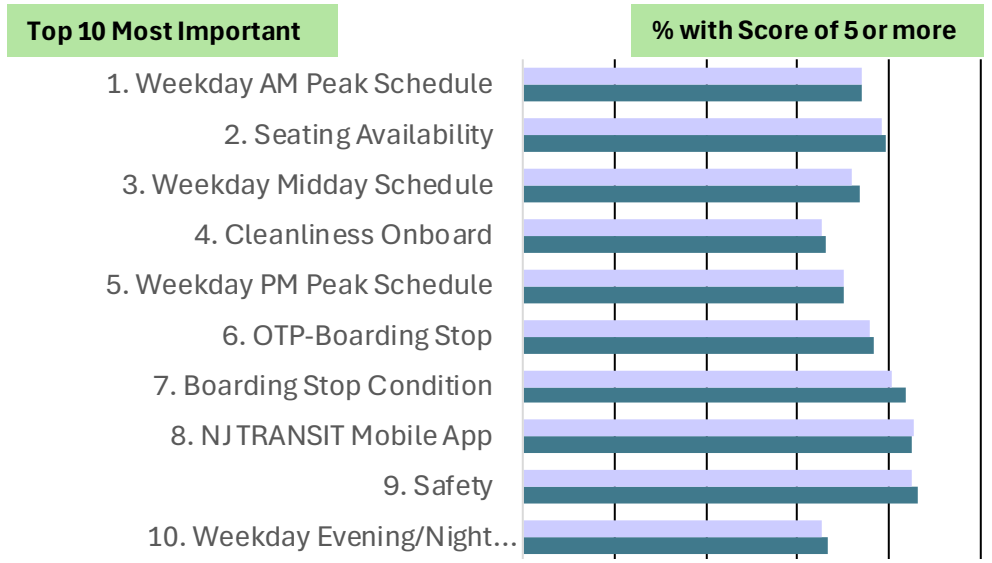
8,728 Bus Surveys

Top 10 Most Important Service Traits for BUS Customers by Bus Market and Score

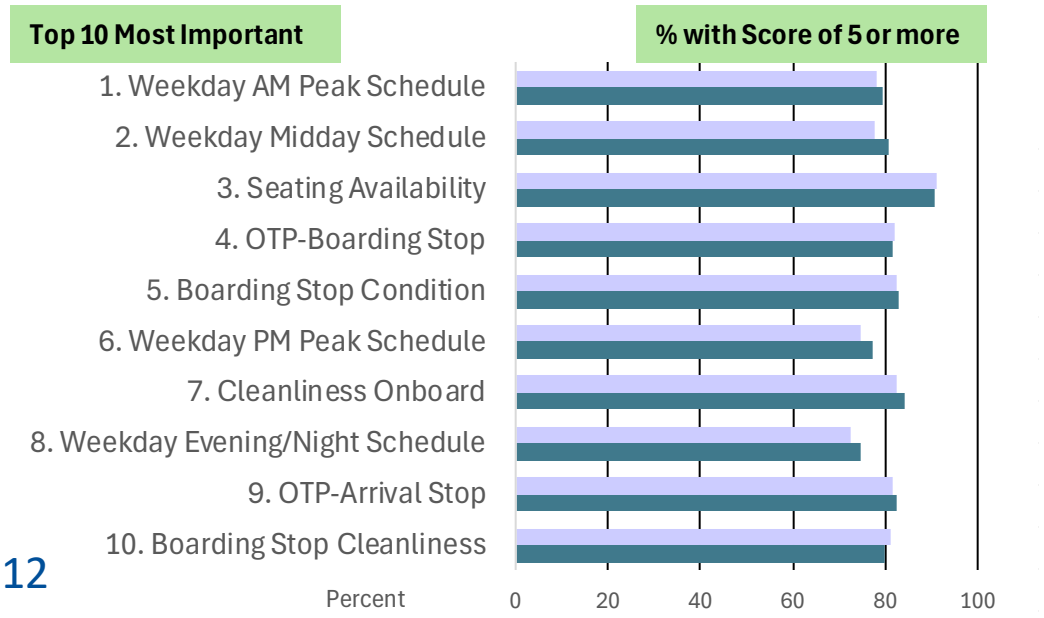
NY INTERSTATE



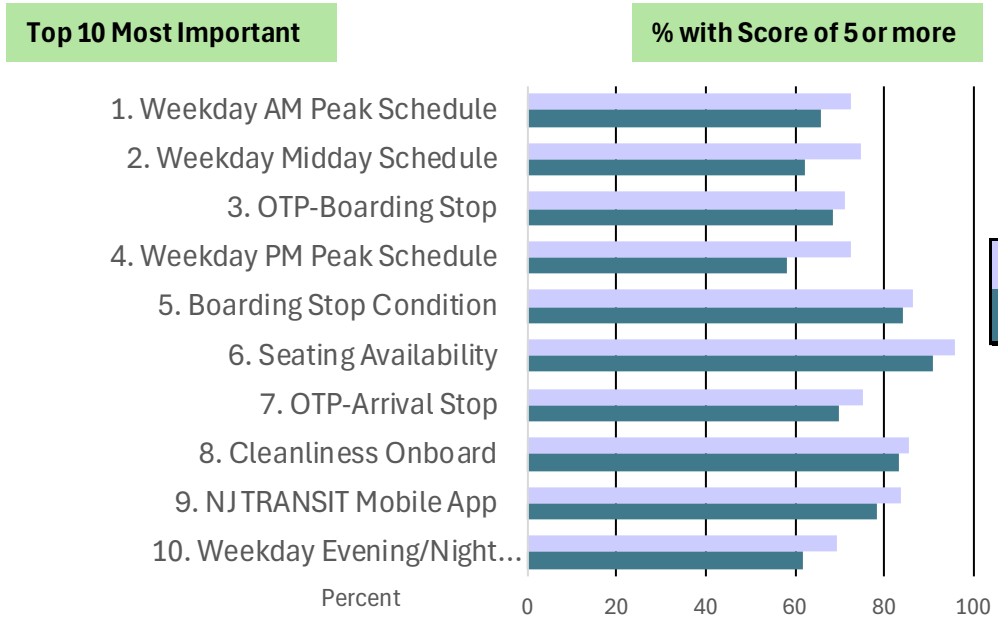
NORTH JERSEY LOCAL

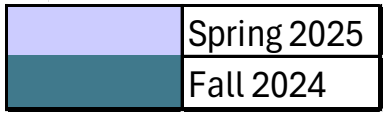


SOUTH JERSEY



CONTRACT CARRIERS





Bus Score Context

Facilities / Payment Options

- Expansion of the off-board fare collection pilot at Port Authority Bus Terminal to additional routes
  - **November 2024**: Routes 119, 125,128, 165L, and 166L, X, and T
  - **March 2025**: Route 154
- Continues to help speed boarding for customers at PABT and ultimately increases throughput at the terminal by enabling customers to have their tickets scanned prior to boarding the bus

Bus Score Context

Bus On-Board Conditions

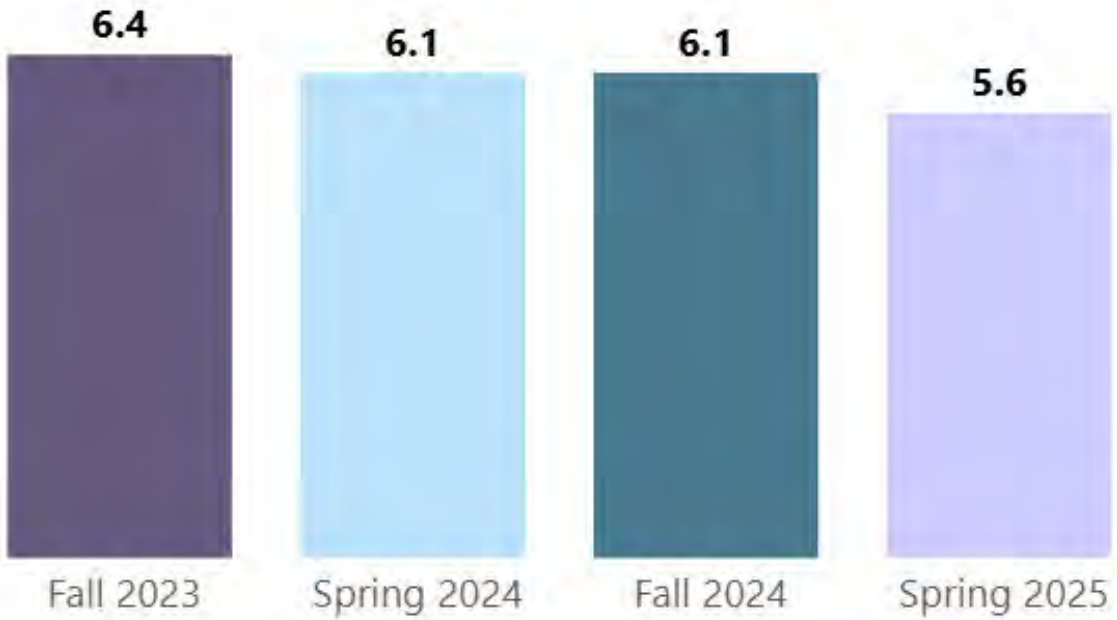
- Continuing work on the mid-life rehabilitation of 200 of our NABI 2012-2013 model year buses, with 44 buses completed to date
- Delayed as a result of absorbing service previously operated by private carriers and having to upgrade those buses as they became part of our fleet
- Includes replacement of engines and transmissions and installation of new seating, which will help improve vehicle reliability and customer comfort

Seating Availability

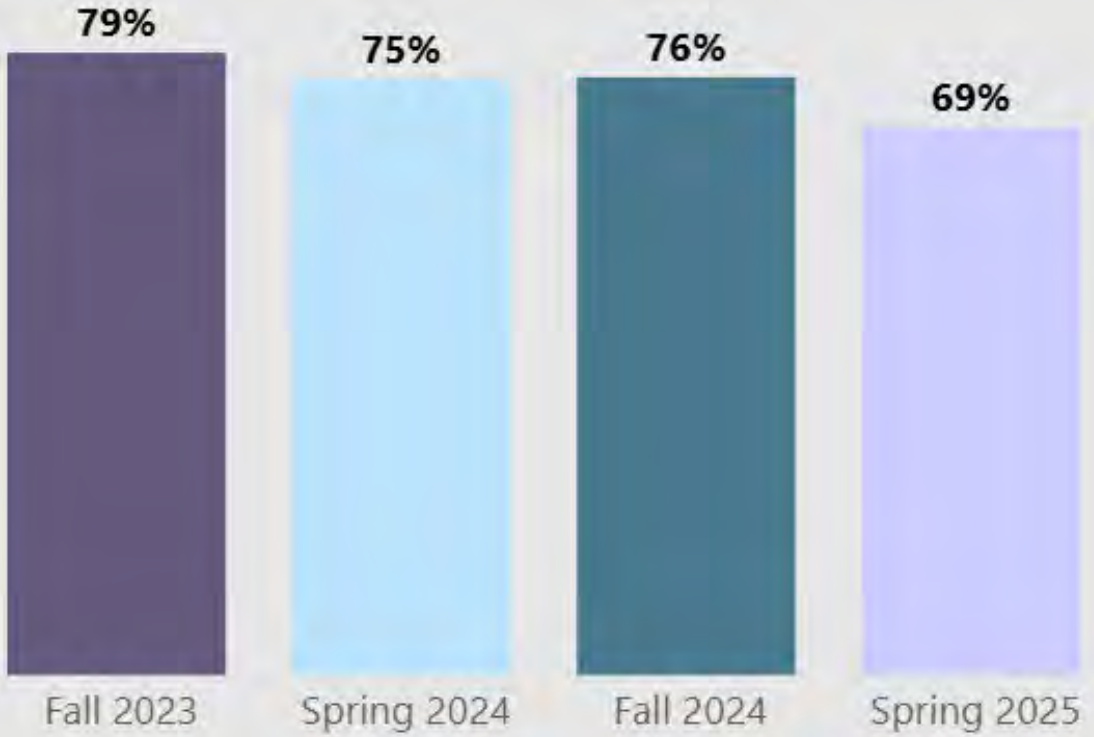
- All buses from the order of 60 new articulated buses are now in service, which will help to increase capacity for customers
- Continuing strategic use of these high-capacity articulated buses on heavy ridership routes to ensure more seating availability for customers

Rail System

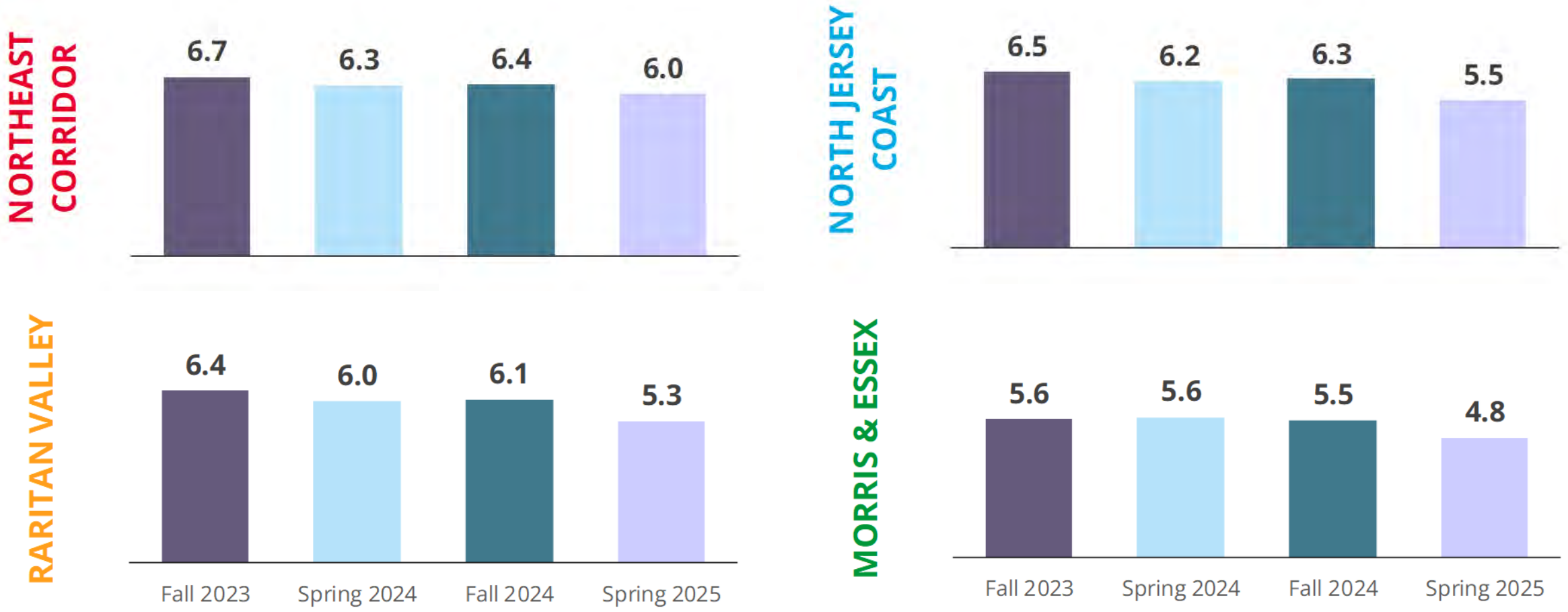
Overall Satisfaction Score



Likelihood to Recommend NJ TRANSIT



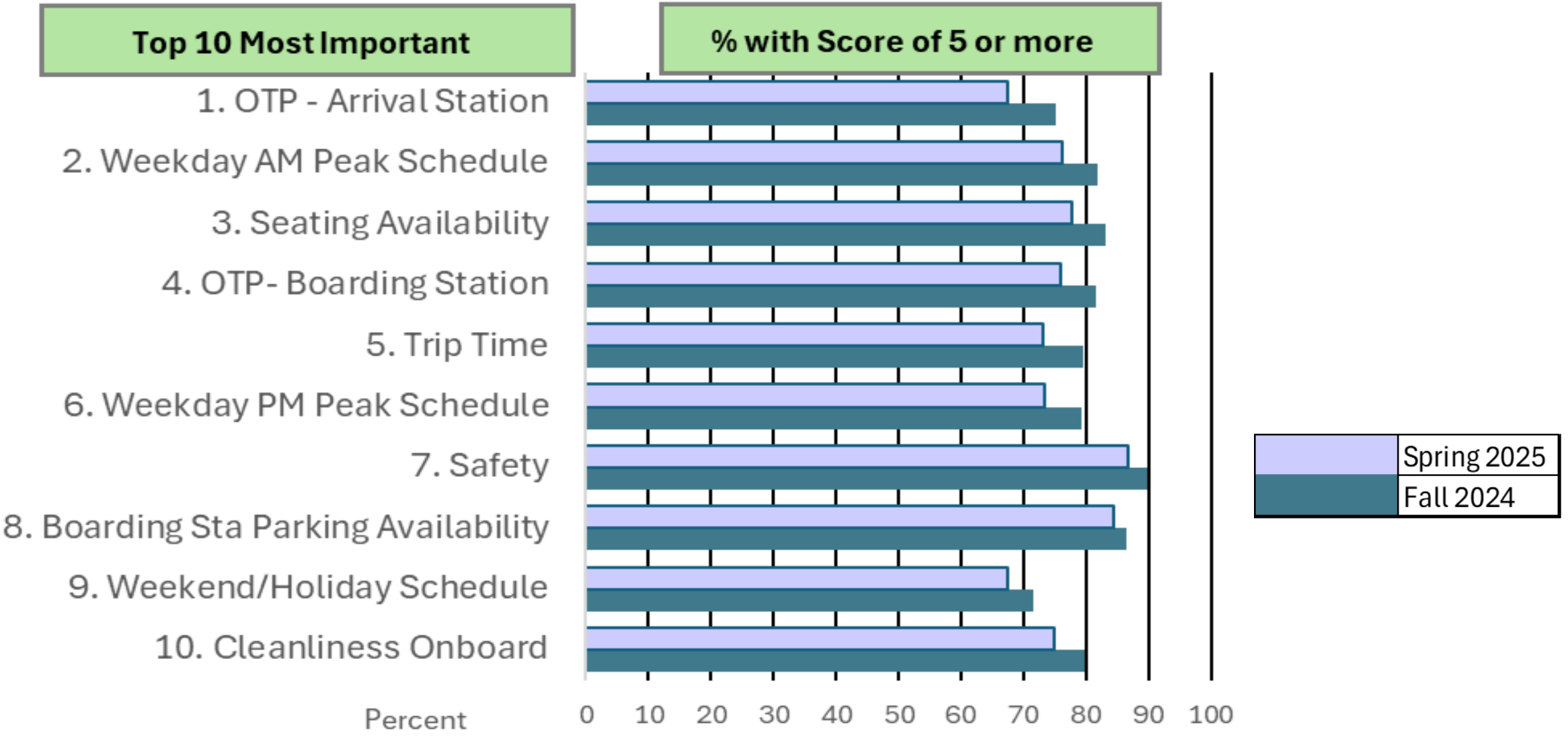
Overall Satisfaction Scores by Rail Line



Overall Satisfaction Scores by Rail Line

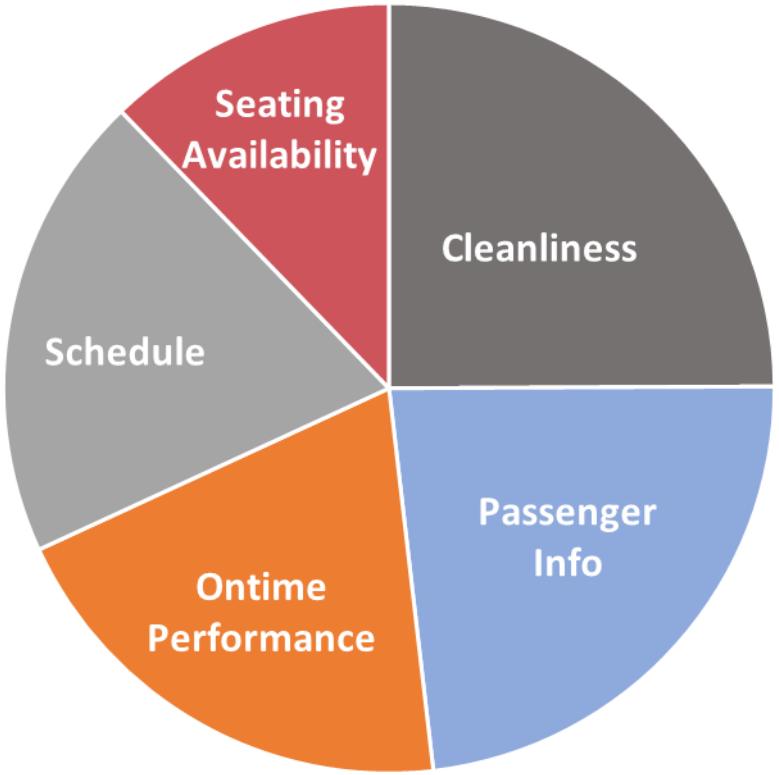


Top 10 Most Important Service Traits for Rail



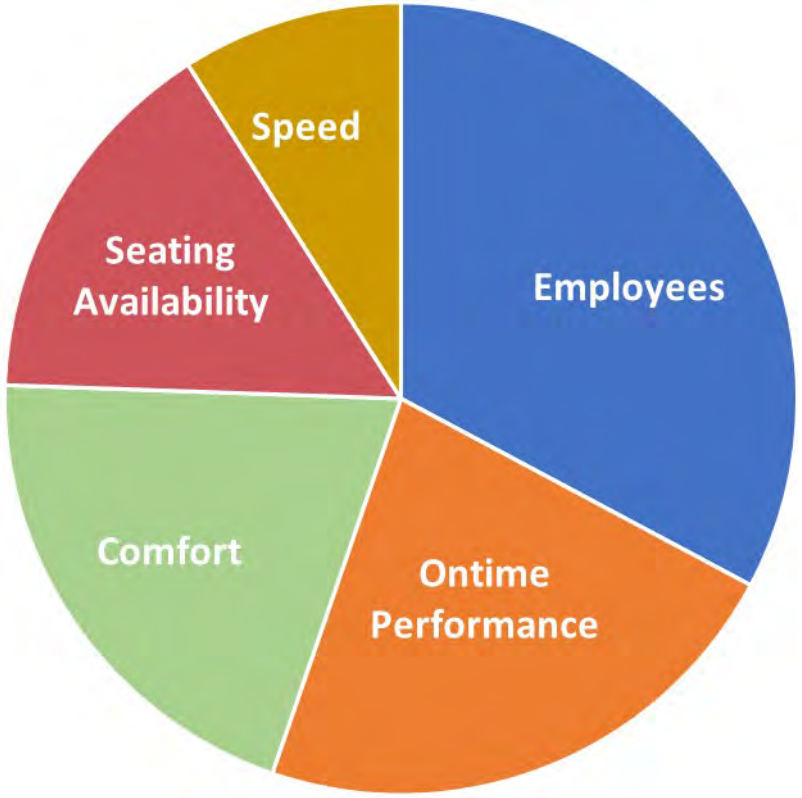
Top Topic Areas of RAIL Comments

What is one thing we can do to **IMPROVE** your travel experience?



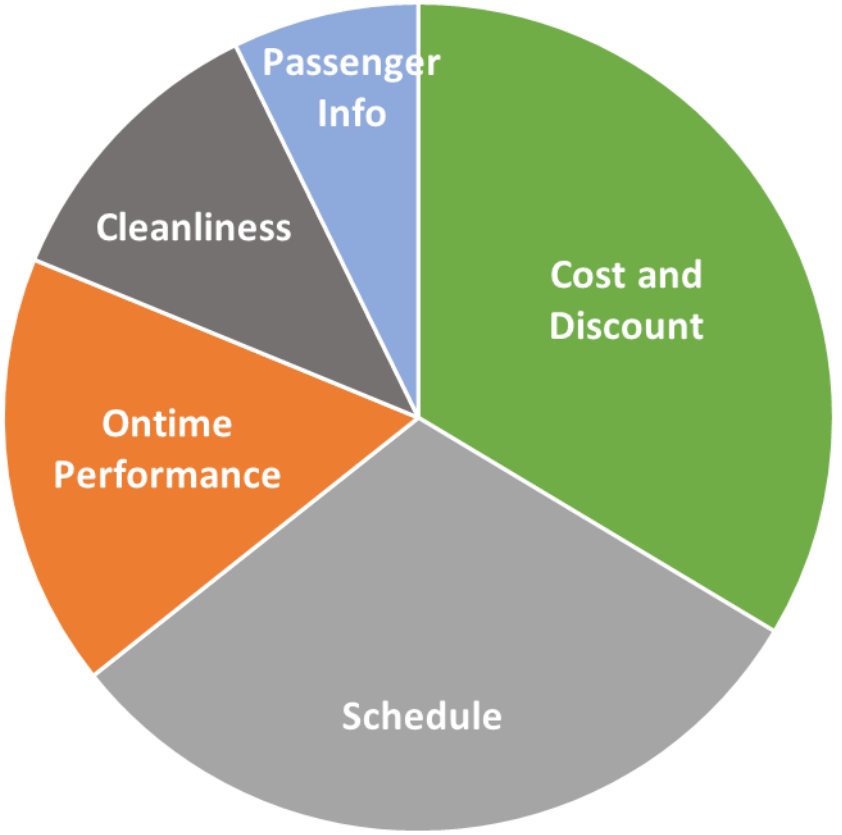
12,445 "Improve" Comments

What is one thing that you **LIKED** about your trip on NJ TRANSIT?



11,754 "Liked" Comments

What are the actions we could take to **ENCOURAGE** you to travel by NJ TRANSIT more frequently?

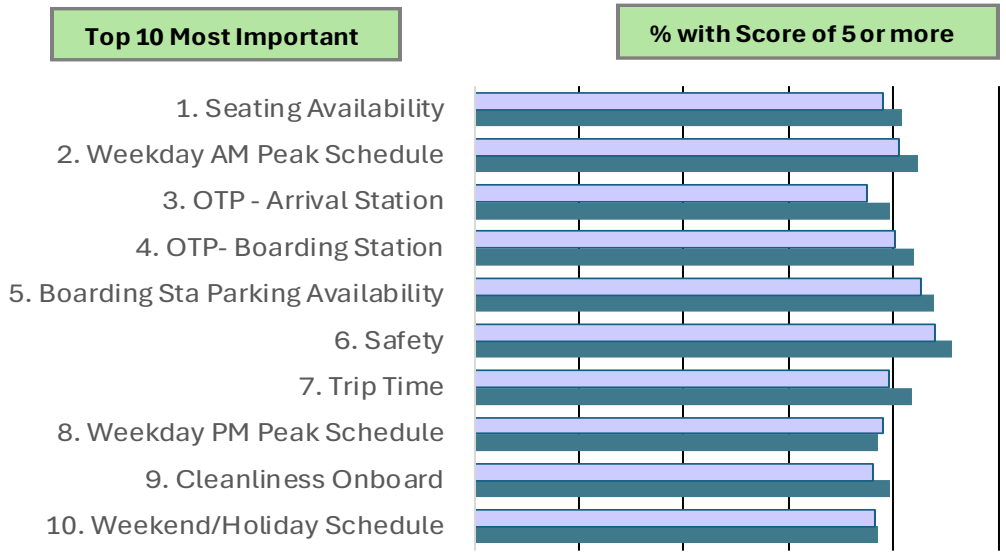


11,546 "Encourage" Comments

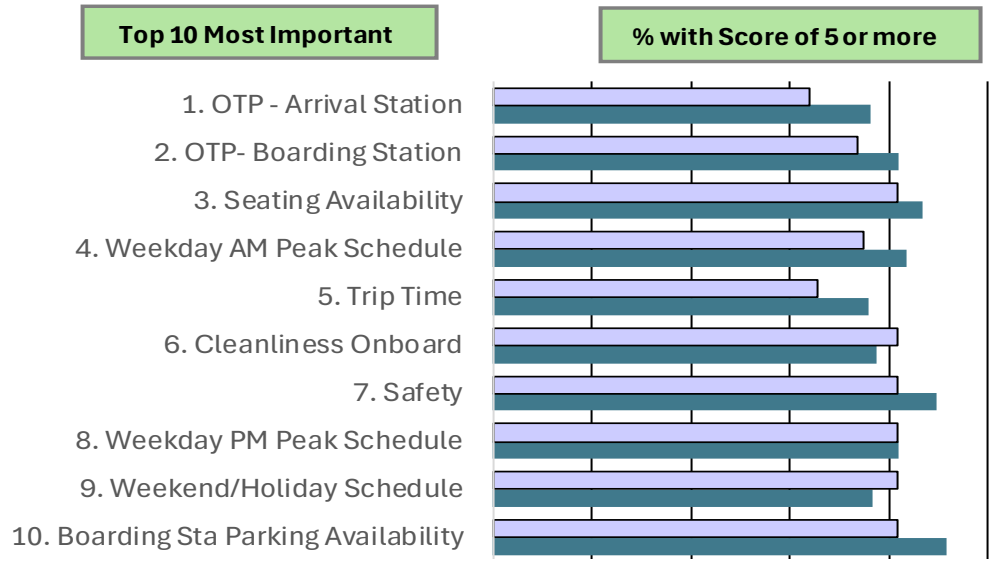
17,843 Rail Surveys

Top 10 Most Important Service Traits for RAIL Customers by Rail Line and Score

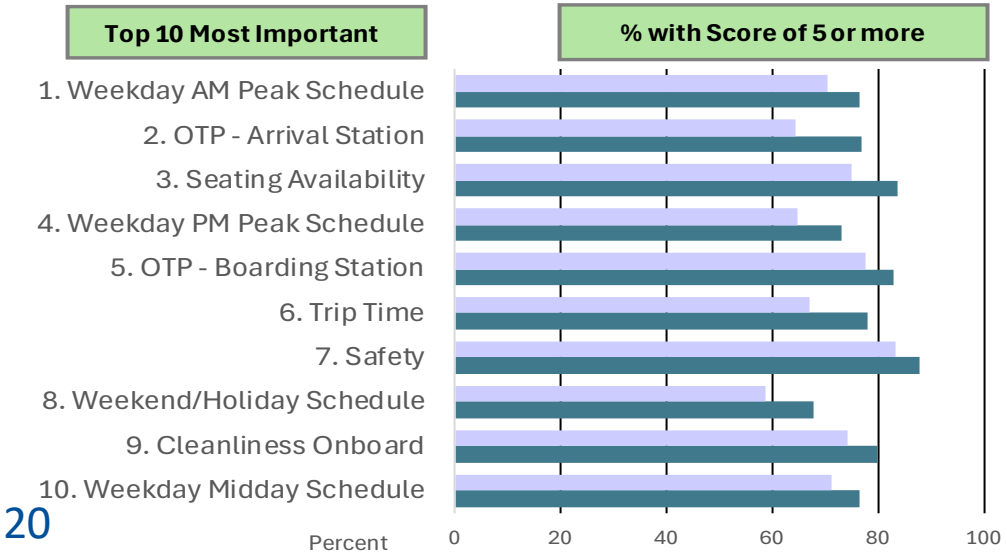
NORTHEAST CORRIDOR



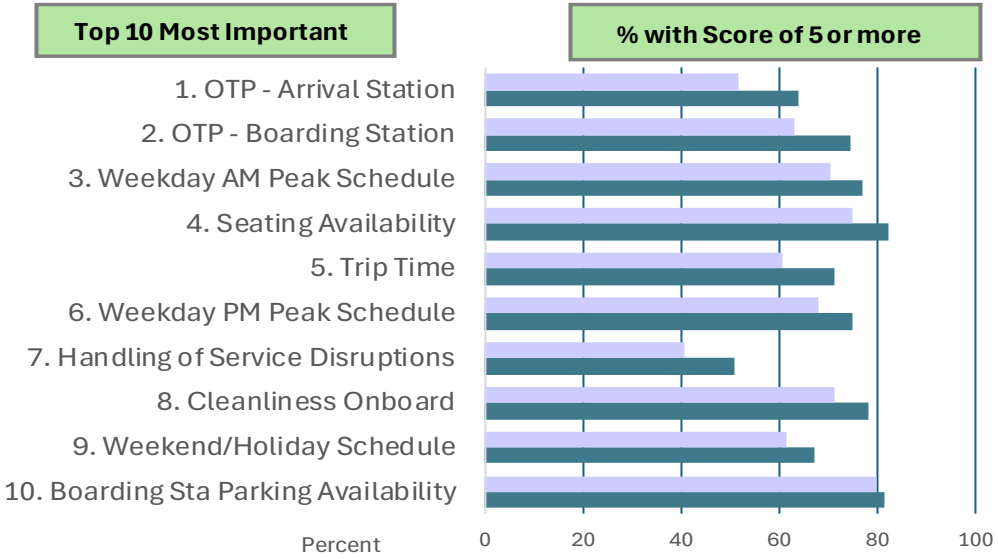
NORTH JERSEY COAST

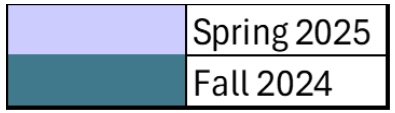


RARITAN VALLEY



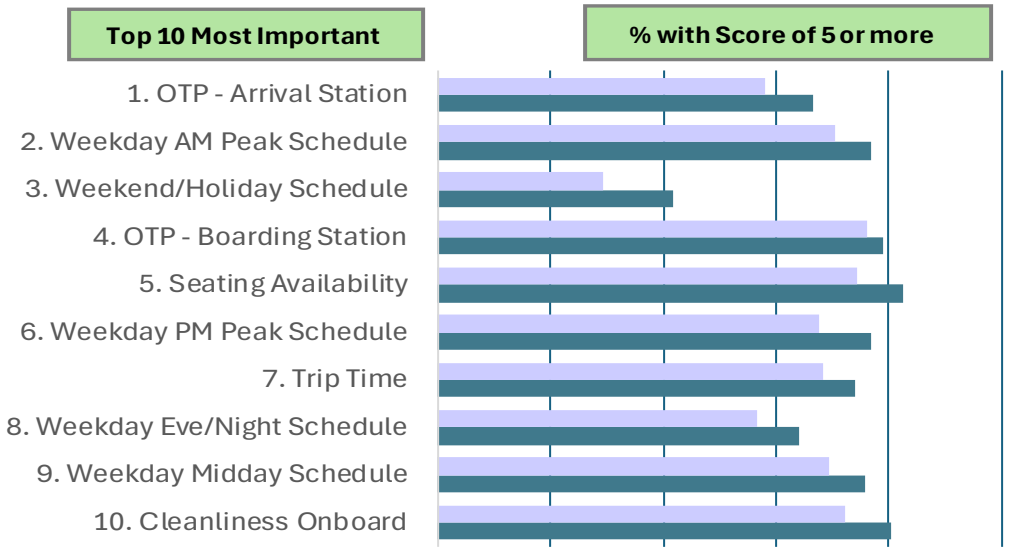
MORRIS & ESSEX



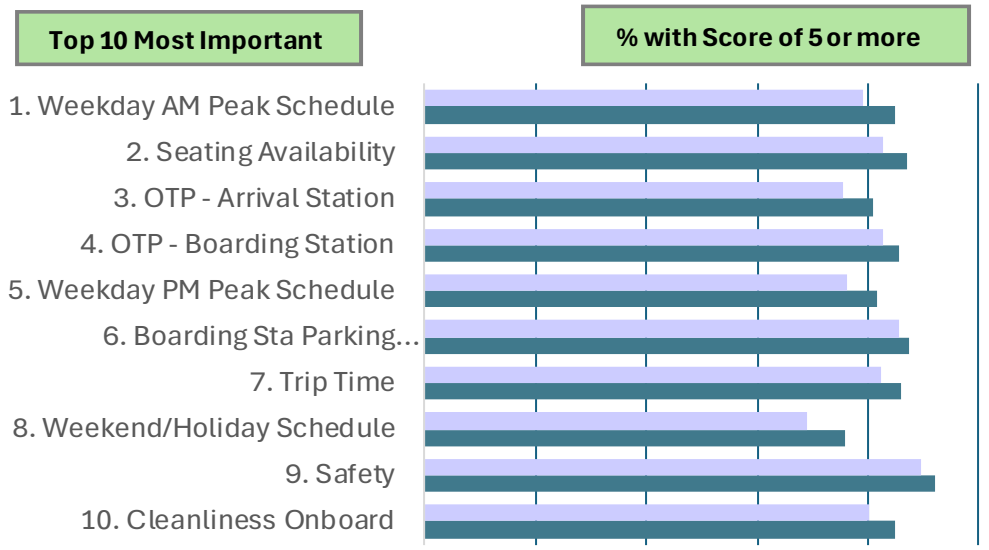


Top 10 Most Important Service Traits for RAIL Customers by Rail Line and Score

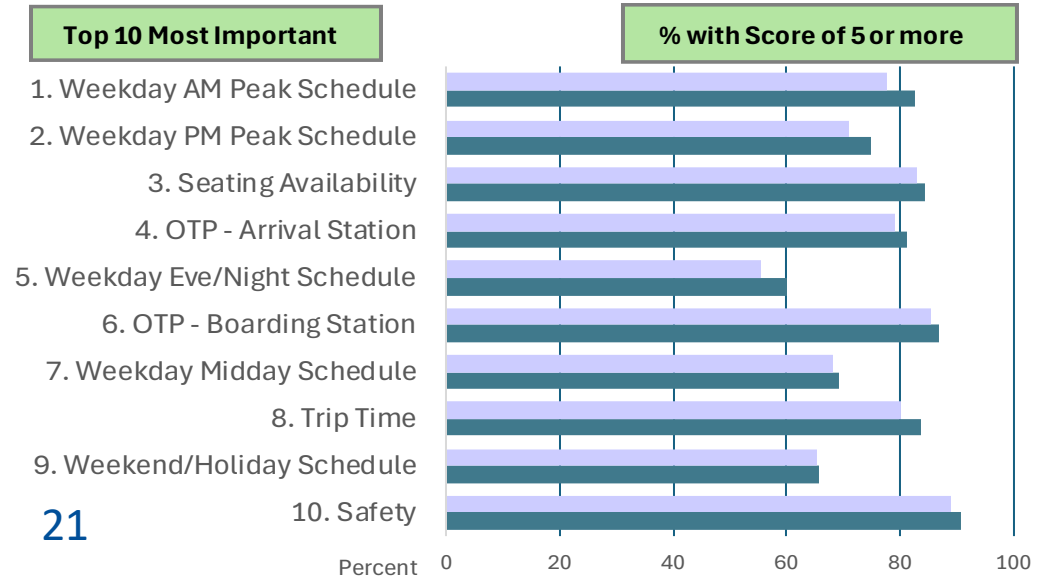
MONTCLAIR-BOONTON



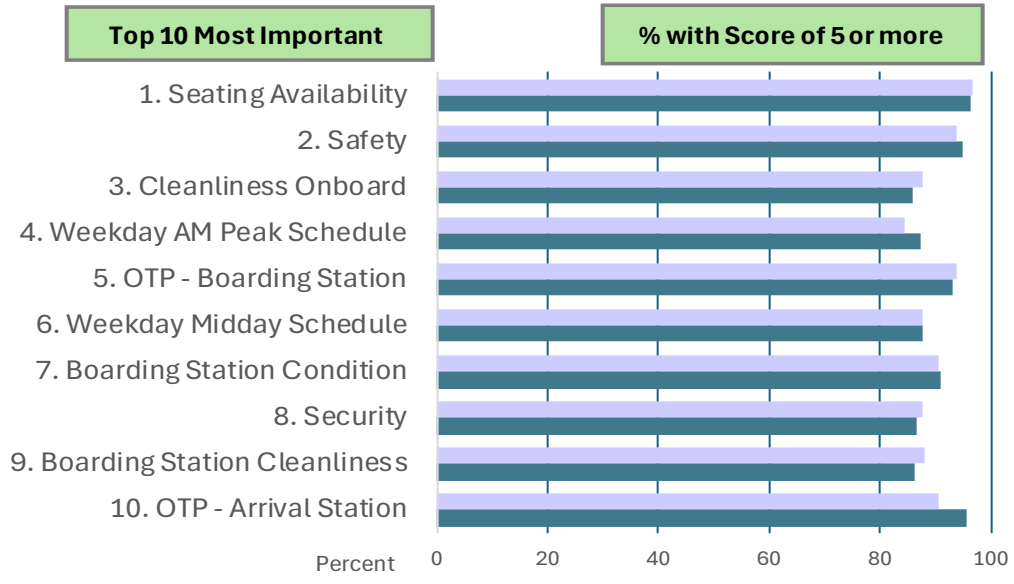
MAIN-BERGEN/PORT JERVIS

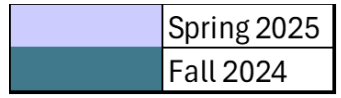


PASCACK VALLEY



ATLANTIC CITY RAIL LINE





Rail Score Context

Rail Service + Schedules

- Survey occurred during the weeks following the first rail strike in 42 years at NJ TRANSIT, which halted all rail service for four days and unfortunately impacted all rail customers.
- NJ TRANSIT implemented a June schedule change in response to customer concerns, travel trends, and other factors to improve the quality of rail service, with our team continuing to monitor the results.
- NJ TRANSIT also detailed a new senior-level manager to Amtrak's control center in New York to increase communication between the railroads during regular operations and service disruptions.
- Our team successfully delivered special event service to the FIFA Club World Cup and numerous summer concerts and events at MetLife Stadium.
- NJ TRANSIT and Amtrak continue working to attempt to prevent heat-related service disruptions and to address them as they may occur, including more frequent inspections of the catenary wires and pantographs.

Rail Score Context

Mechanical Progress

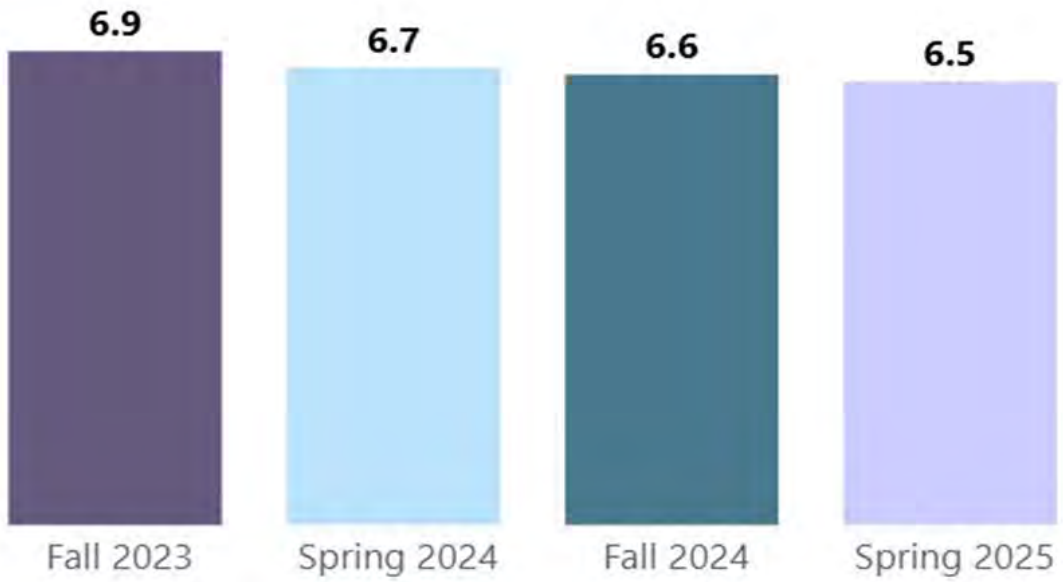
- Extreme temperatures directly impacted the electrical components and systems onboard rail cars, particularly the older cars in the fleet – some of which were built in the 1970s and 1980s.
- President & CEO Kolluri prioritized and accelerated investments to fully modernize NJ TRANSIT's rail fleet by 2031, significantly improving the long-term reliability of rail service for customers.
- NJ TRANSIT's Multilevel Window Replacement Project continues to build momentum, with 71 vehicles completed to date under this three-year initiative.
- Dan Rogust was appointed as NJ TRANSIT's new Deputy General Manager of the Mechanical Department, bringing decades of private and public sector problem-solving expertise to his role.

Engineering Initiatives

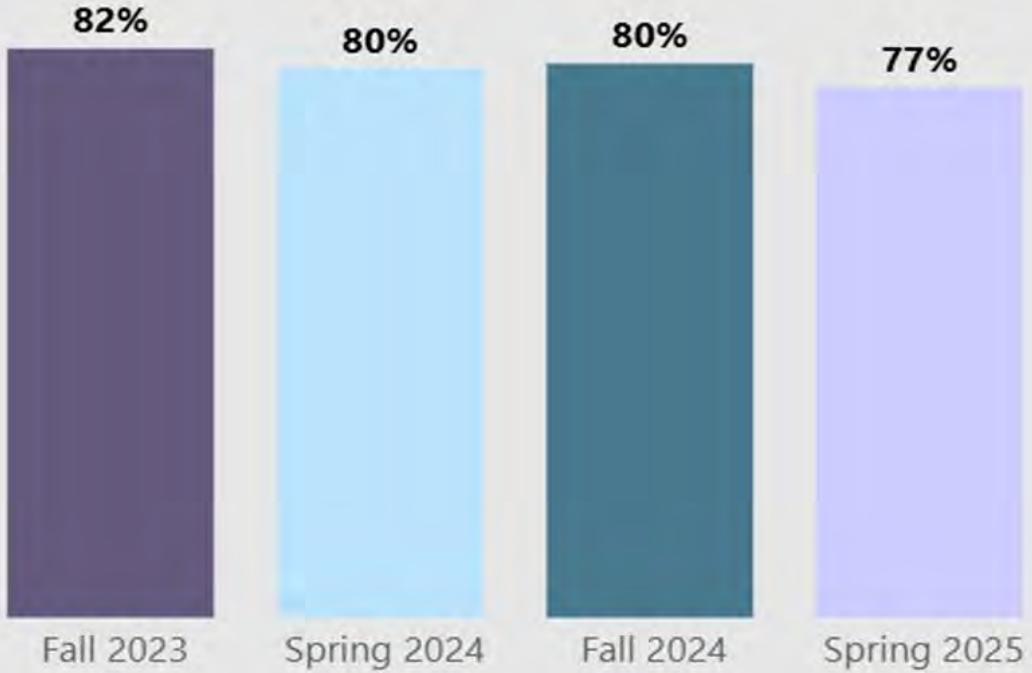
- Customer enhancements such as the Hoboken Men's Restroom renovation and the Secaucus Junction wall repairs are complete or nearing completion.
- State-of-good-repair efforts continue across the system to enhance reliability across key systems, including track, signals, electric traction, and station components.

Light Rail System

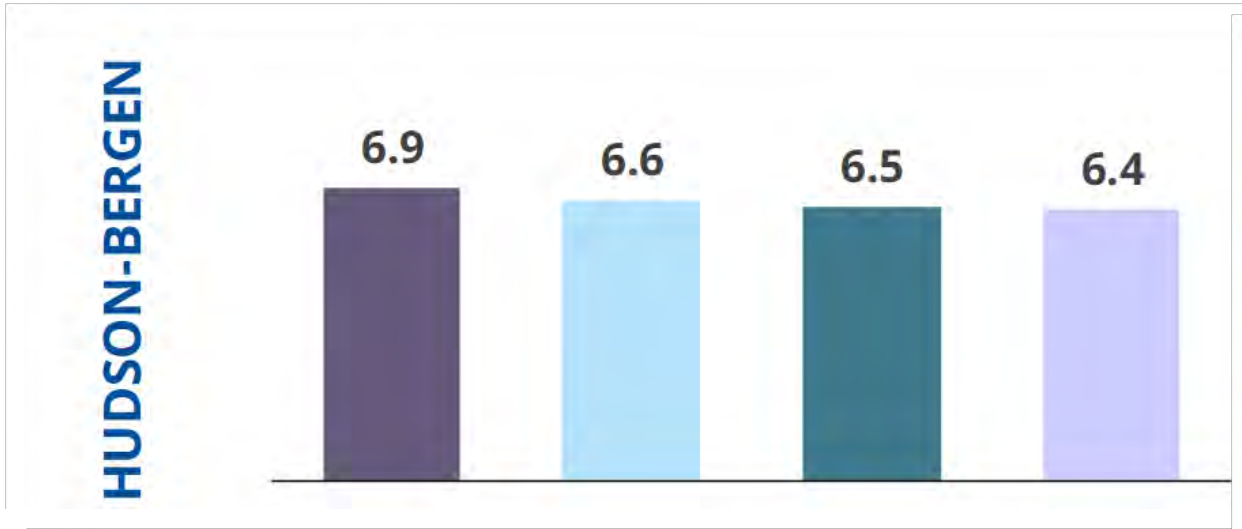
Overall Satisfaction Score

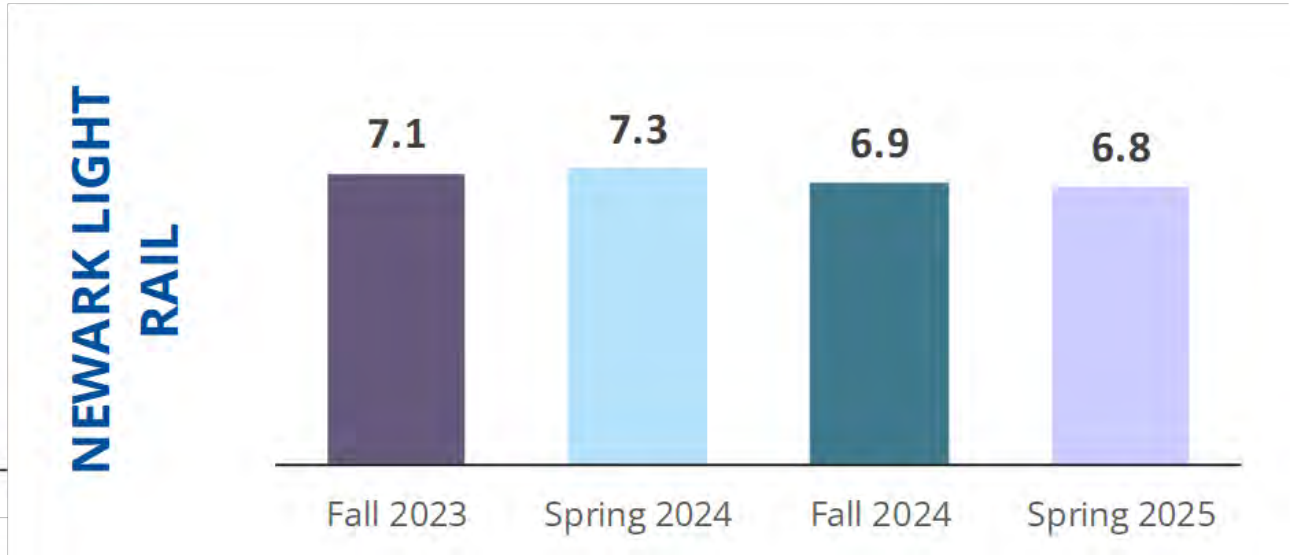


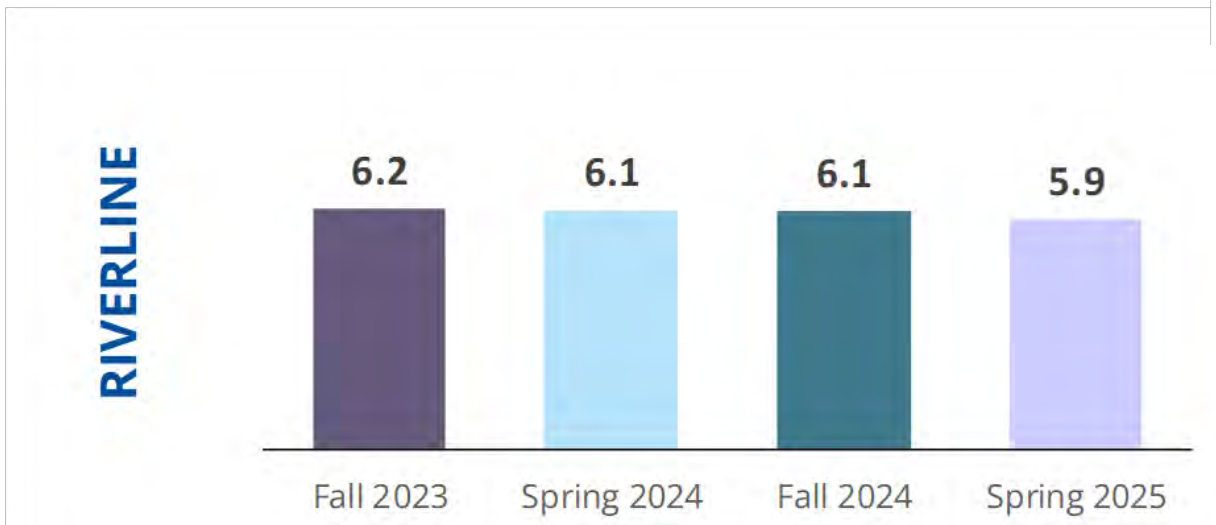
Likelihood to Recommend NJ TRANSIT



Light Rail Satisfaction Scores By Light Rail Line

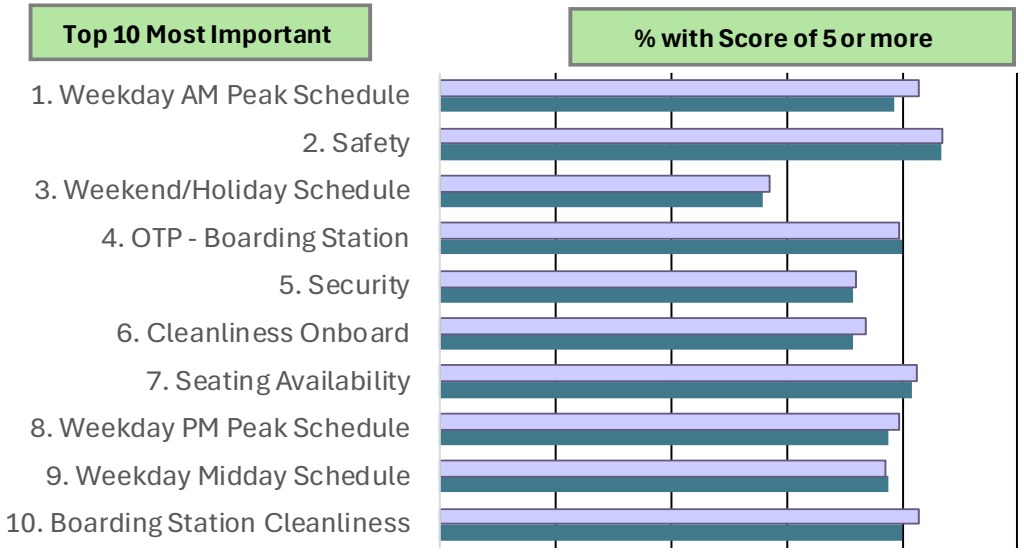




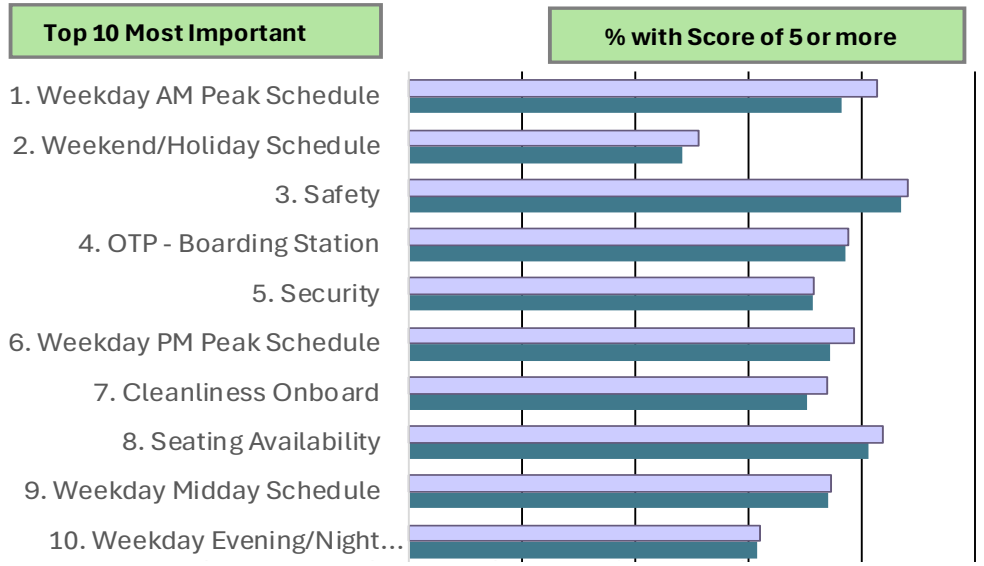


Top 10 Most Important Service Traits for LIGHT RAIL Customers by Light Rail Line and Score

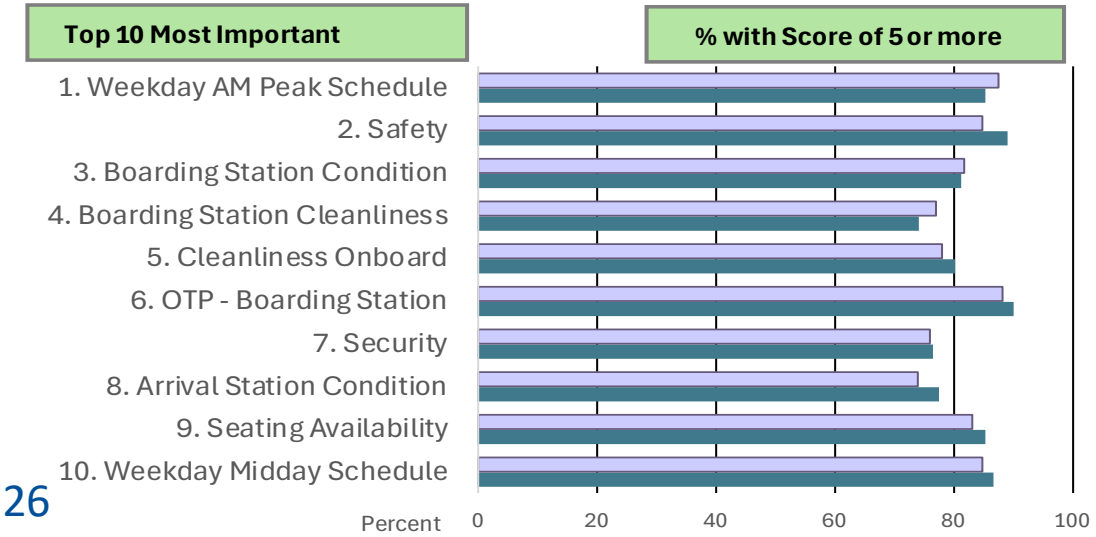
Light Rail System



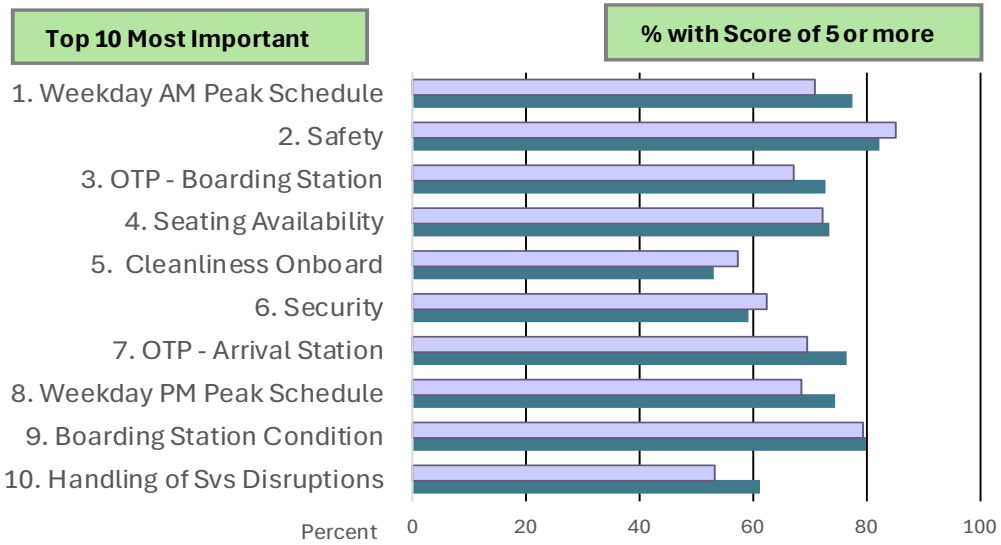
Hudson-BergenLight Rail

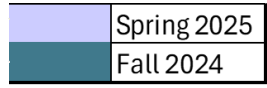


Newark Light Rail



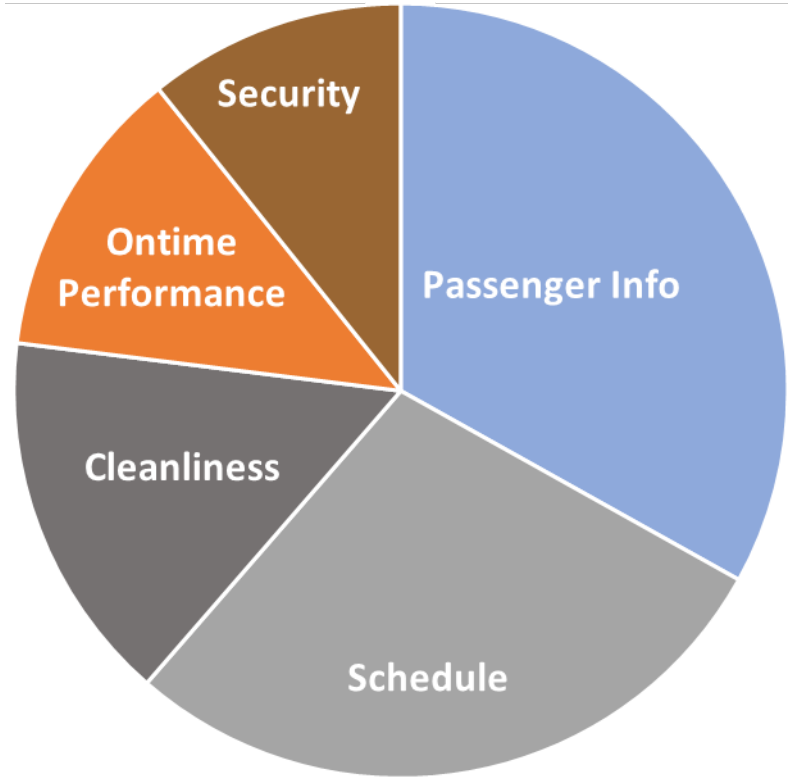
River LINE





Top Topic Areas of LIGHT RAIL Comments

What is one thing we can do to **IMPROVE** your travel experience?



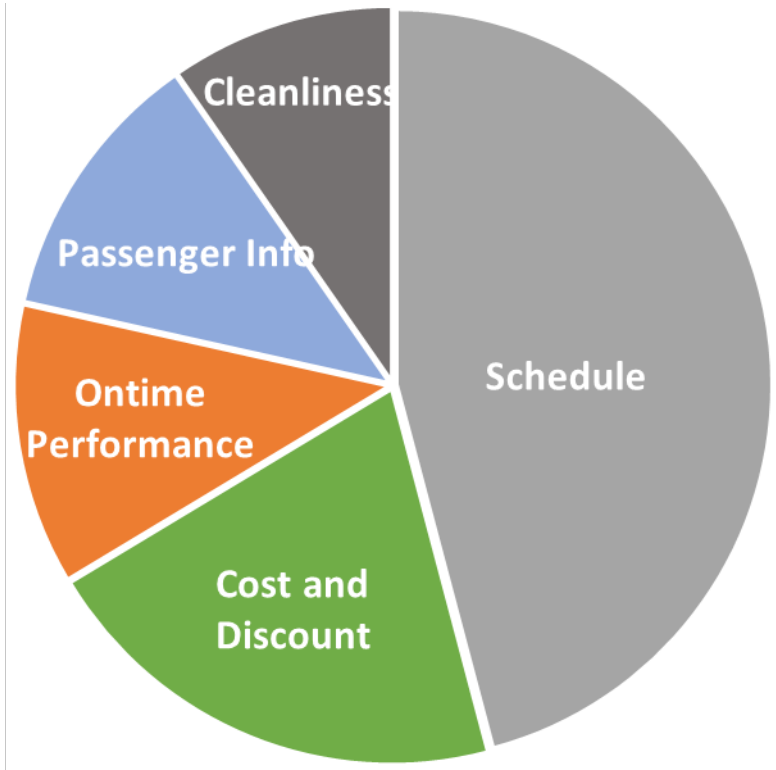
850 "Improve" Comments

What is one thing that you **LIKED** about your trip on NJ TRANSIT?



804 "Liked" Comments

What are the actions we could take to **ENCOURAGE** you to travel by NJ TRANSIT more frequently?



779 "Encourage" Comments

1,336 Light Rail Surveys

Light Rail Score Context

Hudson-Bergen Light Rail

- Parking-related scores remained stable, thanks to continued coordinated efforts with the NJ TRANSIT Police Department to address illegal parking at stations
- Facilities-related scores saw a slight uptick, particularly for cleanliness, as a result of HBLR's responsiveness with customer complaints regarding graffiti and trash and sending out a crew to resolve such issues within a week's time
- Scheduling and OTP scores remained steady overall, while Communications scores dipped slightly, related to customer concerns about receiving timely schedule change information:
  - NJT is taking steps to improve communications with customers by making changes to the mobile app to ensure the modified construction schedule gets updated for the weekends
  - Additional funding for new replacement electronic signboards has been provided, with installation currently underway, which will provide new signboards to 16 stations along the system

Light Rail Score Context

Newark Light Rail

- Facilities-related scores remained stable as a result of efforts to improve cleanliness as well as elevator reliability:
  - Newark Penn Station is power washed each week, which is also supplemented with a daily cleaning regimen by NJT service personnel; adding two additional power washing routines to the current monthly cycle to enhance station cleanliness
  - Elevators at Penn Station are monitored and inspected routinely to verify that they are in proper order to accommodate any passengers unable to walk up the stairs due to escalator outages
  - Maintenance updates and cleanup have taken place at stations, such as Branch Brook Park and Norfolk St. Station, which have had repairs to concrete and railings
  - Additional repairs have been made at Washington St., Warren St., Harriet Tubman, Grove St., Orange St., Davenport St. and Park Ave. stations

Light Rail Score Context

Newark Light Rail

- Scheduling and OTP scores decreased, as a result of a slight increase in complaints regarding early departures
  - Operators have been instructed to use their schedule paddles to ensure they are not departing early from terminals and intermediate stations
- Vehicle Interior Condition scores for also decreased, attributed to trash left behind on vehicleS
  - Light Rail is re-implementing the program of mid-run policing of trash on vehicles by increased cleaning crews

Light Rail Score Context

RiverLine

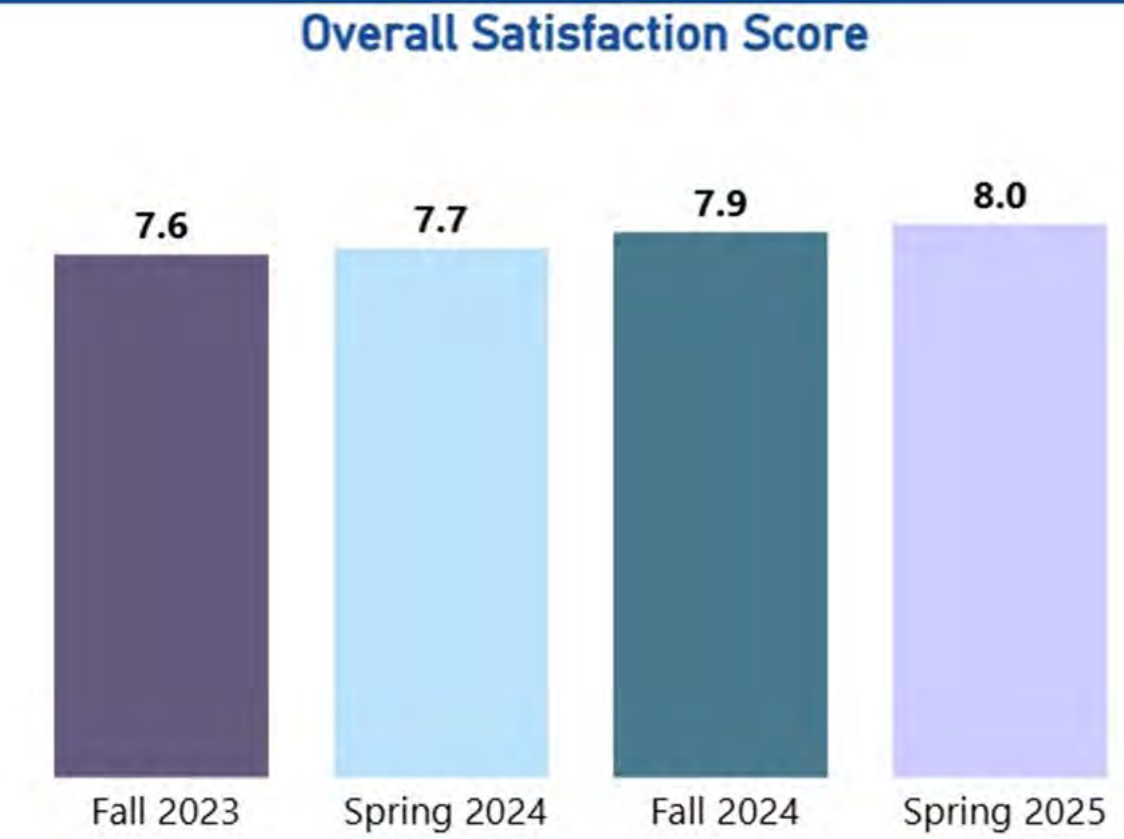
- The overall score for River Line dipped slightly, but with positive improvements for some attributes, as a result of NJ TRANSIT's efforts to work with the contractor to improve service
  - NJT has worked diligently to ensure that the contractor has filled vacancies with qualified staffing as well as specialized skillsets specific to what is needed for the fleet.
  - Additional support/funding was made available to allow the contractor to add staffing/expertise to help address mounting mechanical challenges of an aging fleet
  - Weekday service satisfaction held fairly steady as the result of initiatives to improve service and maintenance

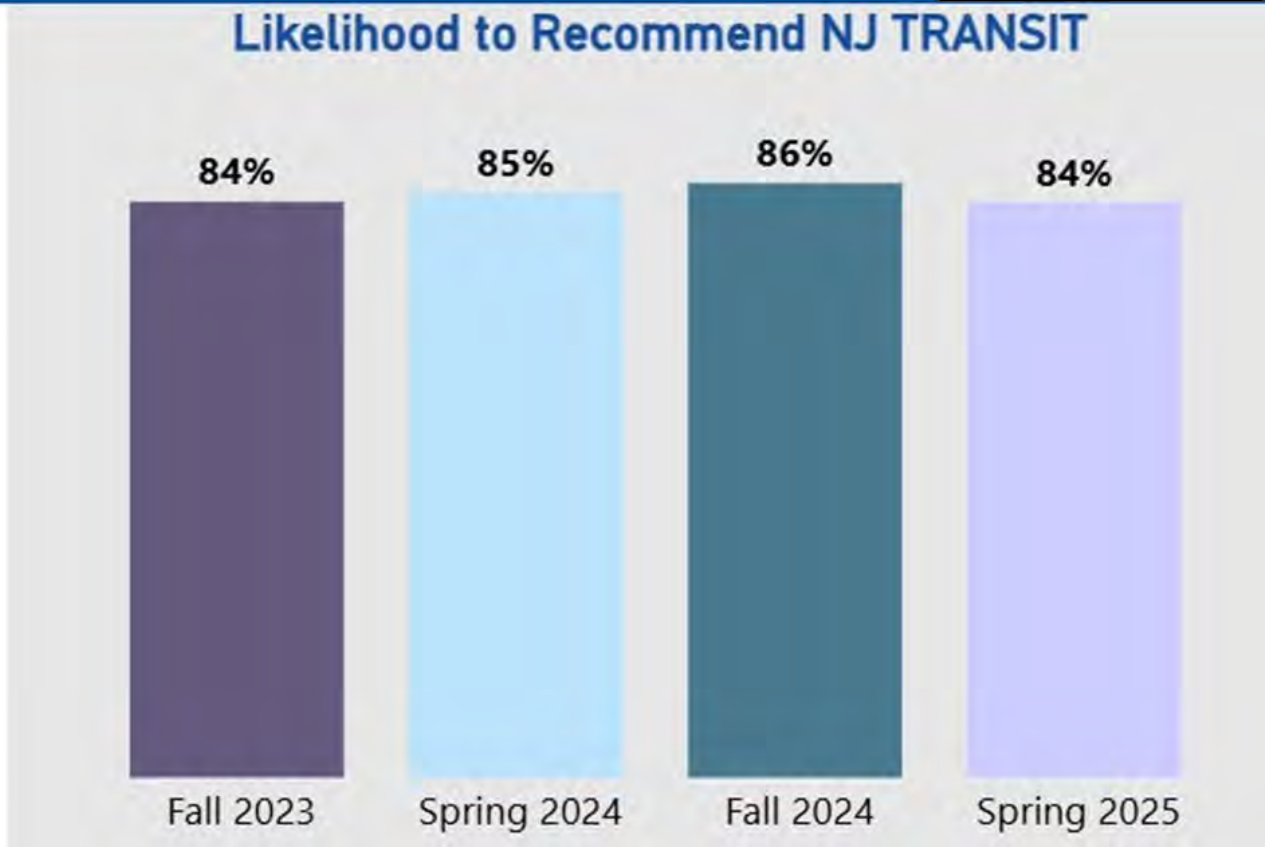
Light Rail Score Context

RiverLine

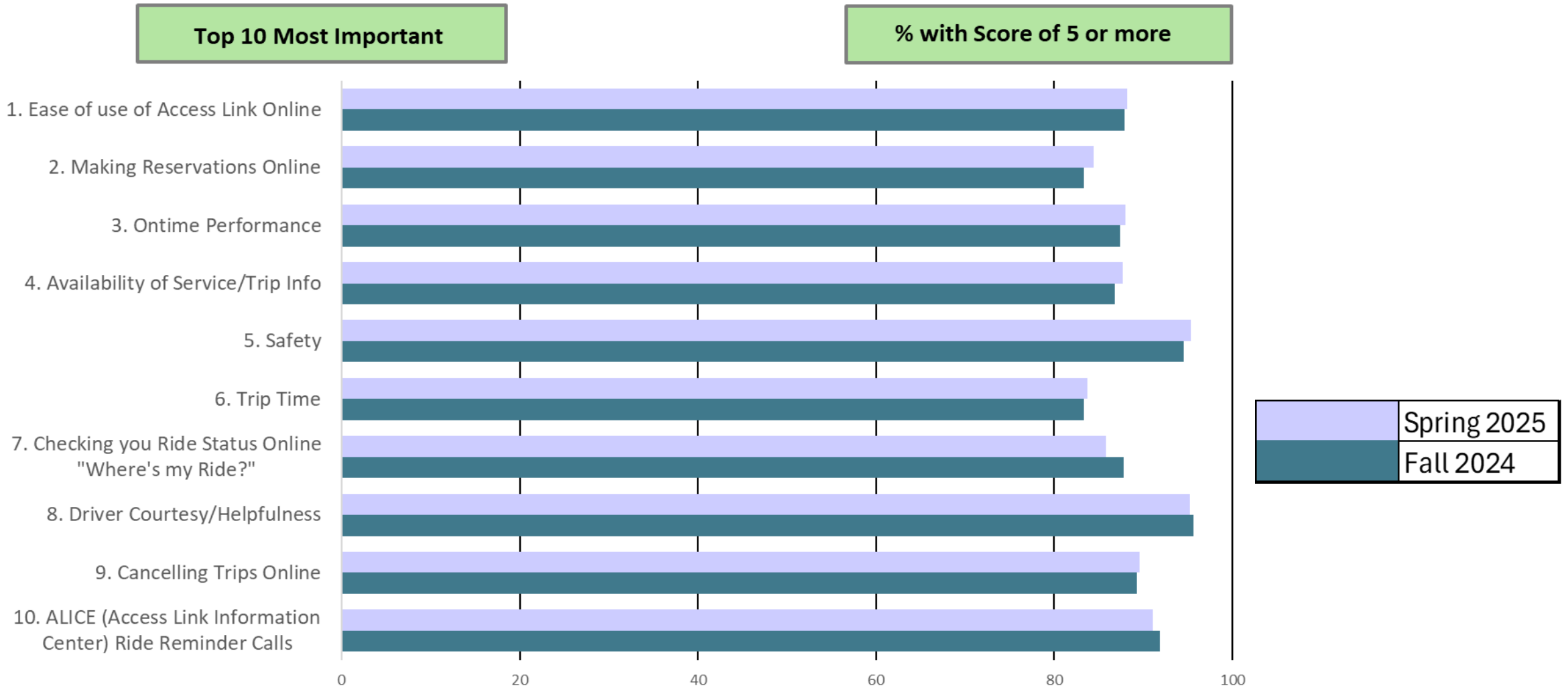
- Onboard Vehicle Condition scores decreased slightly in the area of comfort onboard, attributed to comments related to heat and air conditioning that are being addressed through the vehicle reliability program
  - NJT is working with the contractor to have a dedicated HVAC vendor on staff to mitigate any problems that arise
  - Weather can play a significant role with the overall state of the system because it can impact so much, such as rail, catenary, signal system and the trains themselves
- Scores related to the availability of NJ TRANSIT info and signage information availability improved slightly, as a result of a move to real-time notifications on the platforms by implementing software upgrades that could provide information on the electronic sign boards at the stations and a direct broadcast to the app and trip planners that many of our customers use

Access Link System



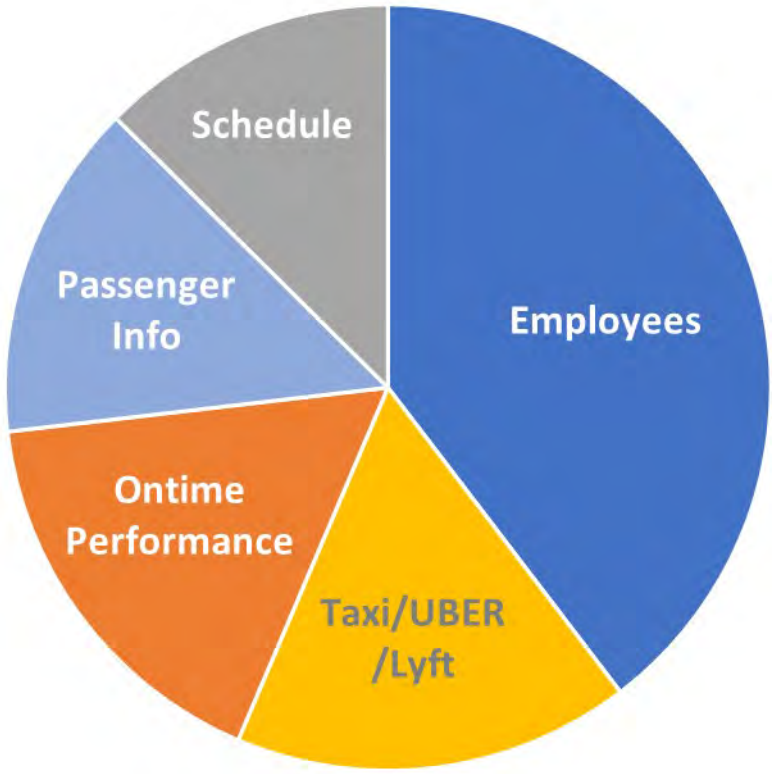


Top 10 Most Important Service Traits for Access Link



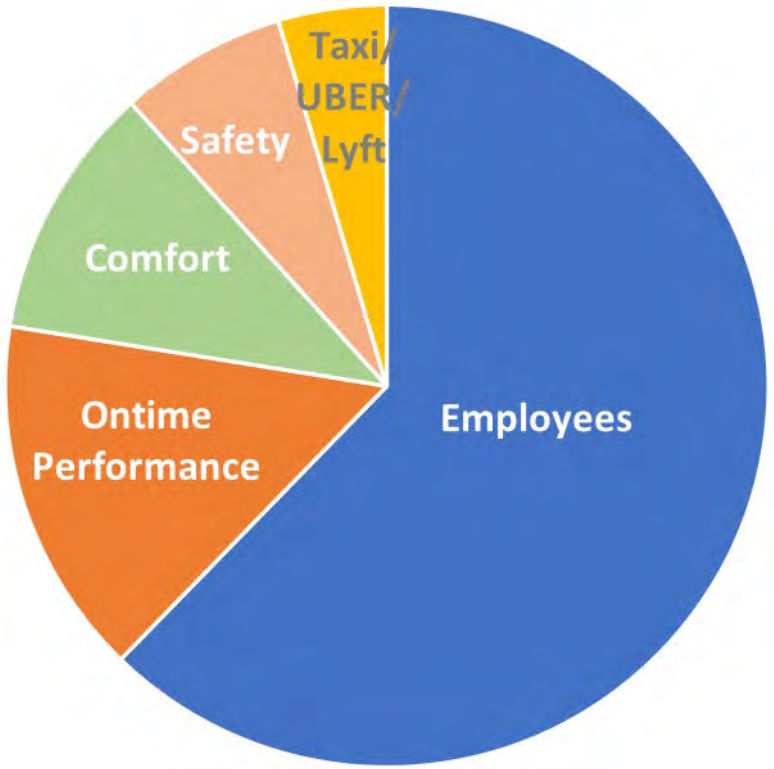
Top Topic Areas of Access Link Comments

What is one thing we can do to **IMPROVE** your travel experience?



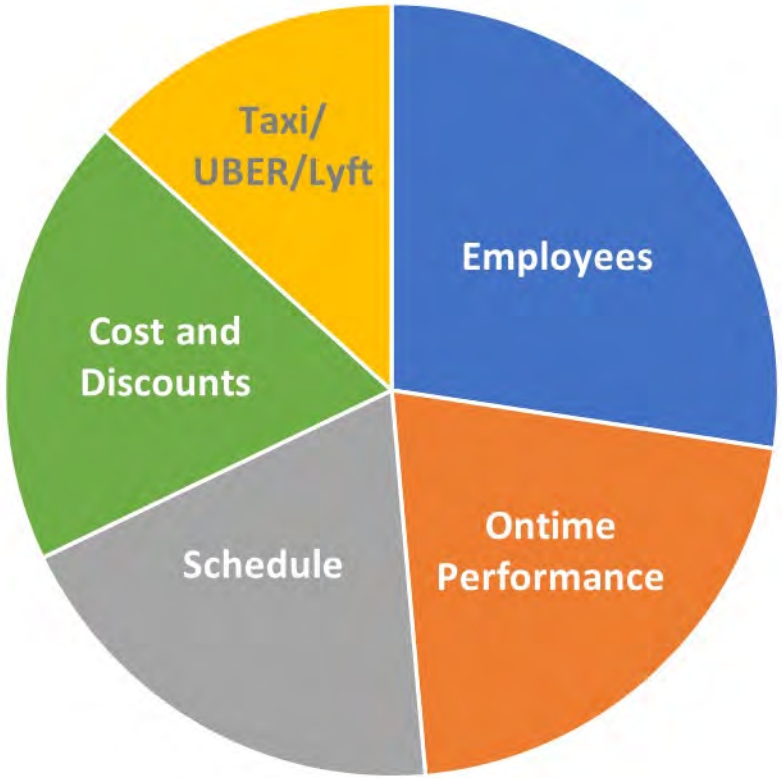
660 "Improve" Comments

What is one thing that you **LIKED** about your trip on NJ TRANSIT?



650 "Liked" Comments

What are the actions we could take to **ENCOURAGE** you to travel by NJ TRANSIT more frequently?



591 "Encourage" Comments

1,149 Access Link Surveys

Access Link Score Context

Riders' Choice Pilot

- Empowers riders with the ability to select the travel options that best fit their schedules and needs
- Offers flexibility, improves convenience, reduces wait times, and promotes greater independence for people with disabilities
- Expanded pilot program to the entire Access Link service area
- Enables Access Link to service customers who are not participating in the pilot with less ride sharing, fewer pick-up and drop-off delays, and reduced call wait times
- More than 551,000 rides handled through the pilot, partnering with Uber, Lyft, VIA, Uzurz and FirstAlt

Access Link Score Context

Interactive Voice Response Artificial Intelligence (IVR AI)

- Eliminates the need for customers to wait on hold for live agents and allows live agents to handle more complex reservation-based concerns
- Virtual Assistant feature has handled 102,084 calls for Ride Cancellations and 43,543 calls for Reservations

On-Time Performance

- Strong scores for on-time performance are due in part to the expansion of the Access Link fleet, which now includes more than 529 vehicles, ranging from sedans and minivans to cutaway buses
- Customers also benefit from increased staffing within Operations which includes additional telephone responsive team members, supervisory support, and additional vehicle operators

Access Link Score Context

Outreach and Education

- Virtual and in person outreach events have helped to increase customer awareness of new services, new initiatives, and updated policies
- One-on-one support has helped customers navigate and use Access Link Online, the mobile app, EZ-Wallet, and TNC vouchers effectively
- Guidance on policies like Suspensions and No-Show rules promotes understanding and compliance
- Targeted educational campaigns and reminders are shared via NEWSLINE, social media, Access Link Online and via email

Summary

- 2025 Spring Overall Satisfaction with NJ TRANSIT Score is 6.3
- 76 percent of customers would recommend NJ TRANSIT
- The scores and customer comments have been shared with the operating groups and executive management
- Scores will be posted on the NJ TRANSIT website
- The next survey will be administered in the Fall of 2025